

CM OPENS AUTOMATED
VEHICLE TESTING STATION **P3**



INDIA'S GROWTH SOURCE OF
CONFIDENCE FOR WORLD: PM **P5**

'DON'T BELIEVE IN
BOXING MYSELF' **P14**



INDIA OFFERS 'ANY HELP' TO END THE CONFLICT

War won't be solved by stopping oil purchases: Jaishankar in Kyiv

MPOST BUREAU
Kyiv, September 3

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Thursday said the Russia-Ukraine war would not end by countries stopping purchases of Russian oil, arguing that the conflict, now in its fifth year, can only be settled through "dialogue, diplomacy and negotiation". Speaking in Kyiv during talks with Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha, Jaishankar said India was ready to provide "any help in any manner" to support efforts to end the fighting, while also defending New Delhi's need to secure affordable energy for its 1.4 billion people.

"This conflict, which is today in its fifth year, will not be solved because somebody is buying or not buying oil or alumina or minerals or metals or fertiliser," Jaishankar said when asked whether India could reduce its Russian



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar with Ukraine President Volodymyr Zelenskyy during a meeting, in Kyiv, Ukraine

oil purchases if the United States imposed sanctions on countries buying Russian crude.

"This conflict will be solved by dialogue, diplomacy, negotiation, and that is why it is something we would encourage," he said. Jaishankar said India

understood Ukraine's concerns over its energy purchases but expected New Delhi's position to also be respected. He pointed to the challenge of supplying energy to 1.4 billion people at a time when global energy conditions remained difficult.

India has faced criticism from the US and European countries over its purchases of Russian crude following Moscow's full-scale invasion of Ukraine in 2022. New Delhi has maintained that its energy decisions are driven by the need for secure and afford-

CLOSER LOOK

- » Jaishankar calls dialogue, diplomacy key to ending war
- » India says solutions will not emerge from battlefields
- » Ukraine says it stands ready for diplomacy
- » Jaishankar meets Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha
- » Jaishankar also meets President Volodymyr Zelenskyy
- » Talks focus on ending war and bilateral cooperation
- » India defends energy needs of 1.4 billion people

able supplies.

The oil issue came against the backdrop of Jaishankar's first-ever dedicated bilateral visit to Ukraine by an Indian external affairs minister. His talks with Sybiha covered the war, peace efforts, commercial shipping, bilateral trade and areas for expanding cooperation.

CONTINUED ON P4

BJP'S SANJAY JAISWAL TO CHAIR

Parliament forms 31-member panel to examine FCRA Amendment Bill

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 3

KEY POINTS

- » Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla constituted the panel
- » Committee has 21 Lok Sabha members
- » Rajya Sabha contributes 10 members
- » BJP has 14 members on the panel
- » Congress has five members



- » JD(U), TMC and DMK have two each
- » Six other parties have one member each
- » Parliament referred the Bill on August 12

Sayed and Kali Charan Munda.

Rajya Sabha members include BJP's C Sadanandan Master, Harsh Vardhan Shringla, Ujjwal Deora Nikam, Alka Gurjar and Sat Paul Sharma. Congress has Christopher Manickam, while Kalyan Banerjee, A Raja, Lavu Sri Krishna Devarayalu, Naresh Ganpat Mhaske, Kaushalendra Kumar, Supriya Sule, E T Mohammed Basheer, Praful Patel, Sanjay Kumar Jha, Menaka Guruswamy and P Wilson are among the other members.

Parliament referred the Bill to the panel on August 12 following opposition protests. Opposition parties have alleged that the

proposed changes could hurt minorities, NGOs and legitimate foreign funding for Christian organisations and minority-run welfare and educational institutions. The government has rejected the allegations, saying the legislation is not religion-specific and is intended to regulate foreign contributions.

Introduced in the Lok Sabha on March 25, the Bill proposes greater government oversight of NGOs and foreign funding. It also provides for a designated authority to manage and dispose of assets when an organisation loses its FCRA licence.

The committee has been asked **CONTINUED ON P4**

Briefs

BRICS: Delhi
govt offices
closed on Sept 11

NEW DELHI: All the offices of the Delhi government, its autonomous bodies and public sector undertakings, will remain closed on September 11 due to the BRICS Summit, an order said on Thursday.

The summit is scheduled for September 12-13, with Bharat Mandapam hosting the main event and several **CONTINUED ON P4**

US warns of
sanctions over
Iran ties

WASHINGTON: The US has warned countries against helping Iran evade American sanctions, days after Prime Minister Narendra Modi met Iranian President Massoud Pezeshkian on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit in Bishkek. **CONTINUED ON P4**

Gemini, Claude,
ChatGPT face
outages

NEW DELHI: Major artificial intelligence (AI) platforms, including OpenAI's ChatGPT, Google Gemini, and Anthropic's Claude, experienced significant service disruptions on Thursday, affecting thousands of users globally, according to outage tracking website Downtdetector.

The disruption also appeared to impact Grok and Amazon Web Services (AWS). According to data from **CONTINUED ON P4**

NALSAR ROW

SC: BCI cannot discipline law students before enrolment

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 3

The Supreme Court on Thursday ruled that the Bar Council of India (BCI) and state bar councils have no statutory authority to take disciplinary action against law students, holding that such matters fall within the jurisdiction of their educational institutions.

A bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana passed the order while hearing a plea arising from the BCI's action against students of Hyderabad's NALSAR University of Law over their objections to the CJI's proposed participation in the university's convocation.

The court said the Advocates Act, 1961, under which the BCI was created, does not give it express or implied powers to discipline law students. Such authority begins only after a law graduate is registered as an advocate, it said.

"For students, it is their parent institution or the authority prescribed under the regulations/byelaws of such institution which alone are competent to take disciplinary action," the bench said.

The court also set aside two BCI communications issued in connection with the NALSAR controversy, although both had been withdrawn within hours following public criticism. It declared the communications issued **CONTINUED ON P4**

FAMILIES PERFORM SYMBOLIC FUNERAL

Nepal flood death toll rises to 1,259

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Kathmandu, September 3

The death toll from the devastating flash floods in Nepal rose to 1,259 on Thursday, while 5,083 people remained missing, prompting some families to perform symbolic funeral rites for relatives untraced for days.

The floods, triggered by an ice-rock avalanche near the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26, devastated parts of northern and central Nepal. NDRRMA data showed 355 bodies recovered in Chitawan, 218 in Nawalparasi East, 212 in Nawalparasi West, 177 in Nuwakot and 127 in Rasuwa. Bodies were also recovered from Gorkha, Dhading and Tanahu.

In Rasuwa's Paharebesi village, families began preparing rites after eight days

without information about missing relatives. Some used kusha-grass effigies as recovering and identifying bodies became increasingly difficult.

Search operations continued for a ninth day. An Indian tunnel rescue team working with the Nepal Army has explored 100 metres inside the Chilime Power House tunnel and plans to bring heavier equipment.

China said it rescued 114 stranded Nepalis from Tibet. About 2,500 have returned, while 1,400 await repatriation.

Foreign Minister Shisir Khanal called the disaster a "Himalayan Tsunami". Meanwhile, officials warned that continued rainfall could raise river levels and increase flash-flood risks. **SEE P8**



Two NDMC staff killed as Thar hits bike in Delhi Cantt

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

New Delhi, September 3

A couple working with the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) were killed on Wednesday evening after their motorcycle allegedly slipped near the IOC red light in Delhi Cantonment and was hit from behind by a Mahindra Thar, police said. Anju, around 50, and her husband Sukhbir, around 45, were returning home to Sector 1, Dwarka, after finishing duty at Lodhi Road when the accident occurred at about 5 pm on September 2.

A staff member of the Delhi Cantonment police station, who was returning from duty, saw the accident and alerted the police. A team reached the spot and **CONTINUED ON P4**

EL NINO COULD PEAK TOWARD LATE 2026

'Supersized' El Nino to persist into 2027: WMO

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 3

El Nino has strengthened rapidly across the tropical Pacific and is expected to develop into a "very strong" event later this year, with the World Meteorological Organization (WMO) saying there is an exceptionally high likelihood, close to 100%, that the phenomenon will continue through February 2027. The UN weather agency warned that the prolonged event could bring increased risks of extreme heat, drought and flooding in different parts of the world, with effects potentially extending well into 2027.

WMO Secretary-General Celeste Saulo said the current warming trend

HIGHLIGHTS

- » WMO issues unprecedented confidence over El Nino's duration
- » Event could become strongest since modern monitoring began
- » Nino 3.4 temperatures reached 2°C above average
- » Weekly readings climbed as high as 2.6°C above-average
- » Subsurface Pacific temperatures exceeded 8°C above normal
- » Current event ranks among four very strong El Ninos
- » El Nino can disrupt rainfall and temperatures worldwide
- » Extreme heat, drought and flooding risks are rising

could make this El Nino the strongest recorded since modern monitoring began about four decades ago. "It may be stronger than anything since our monitoring began, so literally off the charts we have used for the past four decades," she said.

The latest outlook, issued on September 3, represents the first time

the WMO has expressed such a high degree of certainty about an El Nino lasting through February. The organisation expects the event to reach its peak towards the end of 2026.

Ocean temperatures are driving the rapid strengthening. The Nino 3.4 region, a key monitoring area, was 1.5°C above average between May and July 2026

and reached 2°C above average in July. Weekly readings climbed to about 2.2°C to 2.6°C above normal between late July and mid-August. In some areas, temperatures beneath the tropical Pacific surface were more than 8°C above average during July and early August.

The WMO currently classifies the event as one of only four "very strong" El Ninos in records dating to 1950. El Nino is a natural climate cycle, occurring roughly every two to seven years, in which unusually warm central and eastern Pacific waters alter winds, rainfall and temperatures across distant regions. It is not caused by climate change, although scientists say global warming can worsen the effects of

the phenomenon.

For India, the development comes as the southwest monsoon remains below normal. The India Meteorological Department had forecast seasonal rainfall at 90% of the long-period average, with a 60% chance of deficient rainfall. By the end of August, the country had recorded a 16% rainfall deficit. El Nino has historically been linked to weaker monsoon rainfall, although the relationship varies. A positive Indian Ocean Dipole is also expected to develop and could modify its effects.

The WMO said September-November temperatures are likely to be above normal across almost all land areas. Its officials warned that the impacts of El Nino **CONTINUED ON P4**

'Preferential tariffs first, trade deal later': India lays down terms for the US

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 3

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Thursday said India will announce the final details of its Bilateral Trade Agreement (BTA) with the US once Washington offers Indian exporters preferential tariff rates compared with those available to competing countries.

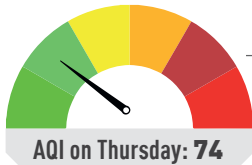
Speaking at a national workshop on leveraging free trade agreements (FTAs), Goyal said tariff levels must be assessed against those faced by competitors rather than in isolation. Countries such as Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, Thailand, Cambodia, Vietnam, Indonesia and Malaysia compete with India in

the US market.

"As soon as the US is able to give us the preferential rate, in comparison to our competition, we will finalise the BTA and announce the final details," he said.

India and the US had announced in February that they had finalised the framework for the first phase of the agreement. However, changes in US tariffs have led to further negotiations. The US imposed an additional 10 per cent tariff on several countries, including India, from July 24.

Goyal is scheduled to travel to the US in late September for the G20 Trade Ministerial in Milwaukee, where he will hold bilateral discussions with US Trade **CONTINUED ON P4**



Temp on	Thursday
MAX 34.9°C	MIN 27°C



Narela: Property dealer shot dead outside gym

Police suspect gang rivalry or extortion motive

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 3

Unidentified assailants fatally shot a property dealer outside a gymnasium in outer-north Delhi's Narela on Thursday morning, with police suspecting a possible gang rivalry behind the killing, an official said.

The deceased has been identified as Pramod Dahiya, a resident of Haryana's Sonipat, he said.

According to the police, the incident took place around 7 am when the attackers opened fire at Dahiya and fled the spot.

Police teams are scanning CCTV footage from the area to identify the assailants and ascertain the sequence of events.

Police, in a statement, said they received a PCR call about the incident at 7.15 am. "One person, Pramod (42), was found dead due to multiple bullet injuries. 15 empty cartridges were also found at the spot," read the statement.

The deceased's brother, Pawan Kumar, who is an eyewitness, said that around 6:50 am, he and Pramod had come near The Gym, when two unknown persons fired at them. Both assailants fled the spot along with one other co-accused on a motorcycle.

"An FIR has been reg-



15 ROUNDS OF FIRE

- » A relative said the incident took place around 6.45 am when he had gone to the gym, adding that he was a regular there
- » 'He was regular to the gym. I got a call from some of my known that Pramod has been shot and is seriously injured. I immediately reached the spot. I got to know that the assailants came on a scooter, opened around 15 rounds of fire...'
- » The relative also alleged that despite the police station being located 300 metres from the place where Dahiya was shot, the police reached there nearly two hours after the incident

istered at Narela Police Station against unknown accused.

The body has been sent for postmortem. CCTV footage is being analysed, and four teams of Special Staff and local police have been formed to work on local intelligence and CCTV cameras.

Efforts are on to identify the accused and their role for further action. All possible efforts are being made to trace the alleged

accused people," it further read.

Police sources said they are exploring the possibility of gang rivalry or extortion calls behind the killing.

A relative of Dahiya said the incident took place around 6.45 am when he had gone to the gym, adding that he was a regular there.

"He was regular to the gym. I got a call from some of my known that Pramod

Woman stabbed to death at hotel

New Delhi, September 3

A 28-year-old woman was allegedly stabbed to death by her boyfriend at a hotel in Delhi's Lohori Gate area, following which he allegedly consumed poison in an attempted suicide, police said on Thursday.

The accused, a Rajasthan native, and the woman, from Bihar, had checked into Hotel Prince on Wednesday evening. Police said the man allegedly stabbed her during the night before consuming poison. Hotel staff found the woman with multiple stab injuries on Thursday morning. She was declared brought dead at a hospital, while the accused is undergoing treatment. **MPST**

has been shot and is seriously injured. I immediately reached the spot. I got to know that the assailants came on a scooter, opened around 15 rounds of fire and killed him," the relative said.

The relative said Dahiya was a property dealer and had never fought with anyone.

Family alleges delayed police response, seeks strict action against those behind killing.

L-G stresses skills, employability in Delhi Universities

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, September 3

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Wednesday directed the Capital's state universities to focus on making students genuinely employable by strengthening training in Artificial Intelligence, cyber security and other emerging technologies. He also called for greater international collaborations and asked universities to align research with Delhi-specific challenges.

Sandhu chaired a review meeting with Vice Chancellors, Directors and Registrars of Delhi's state universities, of which he is Chancellor. The meeting followed an earlier review on May 12 and assessed compliance with directions issued then.

Representatives of IGDTUW, Dr B.R. Ambedkar University, Delhi Teachers University, IIT, DPSRU, DTU, DSEU, NSUT and GGSIU attended the meeting.

The L-G reviewed skilling, outreach and student startup initiatives, stressing that graduates should have skills beyond a degree. He also directed universities to strengthen placements, mentorship and grievance redressal mechanisms, while reviewing NAAC and NIRF rankings and seeking corrective measures where performance had declined.

NCC, NSS units asked to support civic duties, while universities told to expedite staff recruitment and improve infrastructure.

Two women journalists 'assaulted' by Delhi Police; cops refute claims

Press bodies condemn 'assault', demand fair probe

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 3

Two independent women journalists on Thursday alleged they were beaten by Delhi Police personnel in south Delhi's Saket police station. The charges were refuted as "factually incorrect" and "misleading" by the force.

The journalists alleged that police teams detained them before taking them to the Saket police station, where they were assaulted.

"The statement being circulated is factually incorrect and misleading. Two women had obstructed the designated VIP route by parking their scooter near the venue," the police said.

Despite repeated requests and instructions to remove the vehicle and clear the route, they refused to comply. In view of the security and safety protocol of the VIP route, both women were taken to the local police station for further enquiry, they said.

The statement posted from the official handle of Deputy Commissioner of Police (South) Anant Mittal said, "Claims suggesting otherwise, including allegations of assault for asking questions to the Hon'ble Chief Minister, are totally false, misleading and baseless. Citizens and social media users are advised to refrain from circulating unverified and misleading information."

Several videos of the journalists went viral on social media in which both



“WE WANTED TO QUESTION THE CM. BUT WE WERE DETAINED, BROUGHT TO THE SAKET PS... THEY ASSAULTED US BRUTALLY...”

of them could be seen showing injury marks on different parts of their bodies.

Later in the day, another video surfaced on social media in which one of the journalists claimed that they had gone to South Delhi to cover a programme and intended to question Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta.

"We wanted to question the Delhi Chief Minister. But we were detained, brought to the Saket Police Station. The police teams took us to a room, where they assaulted us brutally. They asked from which community we belonged; they thrashed us again," the journalist alleged in the video. She further claimed that she suffered injuries to her leg and arm, while her fellow journalist sustained an injury to her leg.

The allegations could

not be independently verified. The Aam Aadmi Party hit out at the BJP-led Delhi government over the incident.

AAP leader Saurabh Bharadwaj, in a post on X, said, "Two women reporters have been very brutally beaten by Delhi Police for asking questions from CM Rekha Gupta. Shame on woman CM Rekha Gupta."

The incident has sparked reactions on social media, with videos purportedly showing the journalists displaying their injuries in the police station being widely circulated. The journalists said they were proceeding to AIIMS for medical examination, following which the MLCs would document the injuries sustained by them.

The Press Club of India, Indian Women's Press Corps, Delhi Union of Journalists, Press Association and Kerala Union of Working Journalist on Thursday condemned the alleged assault of freelance journalists Shaheen Khan and Nafisa Khan by Delhi Police personnel at Saket.

In a joint statement, the organisations alleged the journalists were beaten at the Saket police station and subjected to religion-specific abuses while reporting an event attended by Home Minister Amit Shah and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta. They sought a fair police inquiry and urged the Press Council of India to order an independent probe.

Briefs

Delhi Metro honoured for HR practices

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) has received the 'Overall Excellence in HR Practices for Greater Good' award at the HR for the Greater Good Conclave 2.0, organised by XLRI Jamshedpur. Held from August 31 to September 2, the conclave saw 23 private and public sector organisations participate. DMRC was recognised for its HR practices focused on employee welfare and organisational development, including AI adoption, sustainability and digital transformation.

MCD finalises Committee leadership

NEW DELHI: The MCD has finalised Chairpersons and Vice-Chairpersons for its statutory and ad-hoc committees for 2026-27. Yogesh Verma will head the Education Committee, while Neelam will chair the Remunerative Project Committee.

Other panels include Licensing and Tehbazari, Community Services, Welfare, Mahila Kalyan and Bal Vikas, Anti-Malaria Measures and Grievances Redressal. Satya Sharma will head the financial panels as ex-officio Chairperson.

Bihar man killed; 8 held

New Delhi, September 3

A Bihar resident was allegedly lured to Delhi on the pretext of settling an old rivalry and shot dead at a rented premises in south-east Delhi's Pul Prahladpur, with police arresting eight people, officials said on Thursday. Md Irshad Alam alias Guddu Badshah, from Supaul, was allegedly called to Delhi by Shamshad and Ashafak, also from Supaul. Police said the meeting was a trap and Alam was shot dead on July 28. Md Farukh, found injured at the scene, initially claimed to be a victim but was arrested after interrogation, call-record analysis and technical surveillance exposed inconsistencies in his account.

The accused were iden-

tified as Farukh, Aftab, Irfan, Shamshad, Ashafak, Rahmatullah alias Chhotu, Shoib Akhtar and Aman Yadav. Police said they played different roles in planning the murder, arranging accommodation and transport, executing the attack and concealing evidence.

Aftab was traced to Tiruppur in Tamil Nadu, while an illegal pistol, magazine and live cartridges were recovered from Irfan following his disclosure. Police said the accused switched off phones and used internet-based communication to evade arrest but were traced through technical surveillance, CCTV footage, movement tracking and field intelligence. **MPST**

Anyone, not just parents, can pay Rs 1 lakh surety for students: HC

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 3

The Delhi High Court on Thursday ruled that candidates contesting the upcoming DUSU elections need not have their parents stand as surety for the Rs 1 lakh bond required by Delhi University. Justice Jasmeet Singh said the surety could be furnished by anyone, including a guardian, who has the financial means to pay the amount.

The court was hearing a plea by AISA activists Ananya Raturi and Akshat Shikhar challenging the election affa-

DUSU POLLS



vit requiring parental or guardian consent and a Rs 1 lakh surety. The affidavit requires candidates to indemnify the university or college for violations of election guidelines, including defacement of property.

DU defended the provision, saying it was also in place during the 2025 elections and was intended to

prevent damage to college property during campaigning. The court observed that election periods are chaotic and college walls are often left in poor condition afterwards.

AISA argued that the requirement undermines the autonomy of adult students and could disproportionately affect women and financially independent candidates. The organisation also criticised the financial burden imposed by the indemnity requirement.

The DUSU elections are scheduled for September 18, with counting and results on September 19.

BRICS SUMMIT

Police holds security coordination meet

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 3

Delhi Police on Thursday held an interstate meeting with senior police officers from neighbouring states and the Union Territory of Chandigarh to strengthen security coordination and ensure an incident-free BRICS Summit in the national capital. The summit is scheduled from September 11 to 13.

The meeting, chaired by Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar, was attended by senior officers from Haryana, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan and Chandigarh, officials said.

During the meeting, officers shared intelligence inputs and discussed mea-



sures relating to border checking, traffic regulation and verification of suspicious persons and vehicles, a senior police officer said.

The movement of drones and other flying objects from open areas was also discussed, with officials stressing the need for close coordination and timely sharing of information regarding any suspicious activity.

The Delhi Police

emphasised the importance of providing advance information to neighbouring states about the movement of suspicious persons or vehicles, he said.

Traffic restrictions to be imposed during the summit and measures to prevent unauthorised intrusion through borders were also discussed and shared with officers from the neighbouring states.

Senior Delhi Police officers, including special

MEET, CHAIRED BY ANURAG KUMAR, WAS ATTENDED BY SENIOR OFFICERS FROM HARYANA, PUNJAB, UTTAR PRADESH, RAJ...

commissioners of police overseeing law and order, special cell, traffic, security, crime, transport and intelligence, also participated in the meeting.

Joint director, SIB/Delhi, joint and additional commissioners of police handling various ranges and specialised units, and deputy commissioners of police from districts, crime, IGI Airport and PCR were also present.

The participating states

and Chandigarh assured Delhi Police of full cooperation and coordination for effective implementation of the security and traffic measures, the officer said.

The Delhi Police commissioner appreciated the cooperation extended by neighbouring police forces during previous events and sought similar coordination during the BRICS Summit.

The commissioner stressed minimal public inconvenience during the summit, with wider publicity of traffic restrictions and alternative routes. NCR police were asked to issue advisories, while affected routes should remain free of encroachments and unauthorised parking.

ONE-DAY WORKSHOP SPUWAC trains NCC cadets in self-defence

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, September 3

The Self-Defence Wing of the Special Police Unit for Women & Children (SPUWAC), Delhi Police, conducted a one-day self-defence workshop for 450 NCC cadets at Group HQ Delhi 'C' in Safdarjung Enclave, officials said.

The workshop, organised as part of the ongoing Combined Annual Training Camp 2026, was held under the supervision of the DCP, SPUWAC. It aimed to equip cadets with practical self-defence skills while enhancing their situational awareness and confidence in dealing with challenging situations.

During the session,

SPUWAC trainers demonstrated basic self-defence techniques and guided cadets on responding to potential threats.

They stressed the importance of staying vigilant and acting promptly during dangerous situations to ensure personal safety.

The interactive workshop received an enthusiastic response from the NCC cadets, officials said.

The SPUWAC regularly conducts self-defence training, safety awareness and community outreach programmes to empower girls and young women, promote preparedness and foster a culture of personal safety.

FLAGS OFF 50 E-BUSES

CM opens automated vehicle testing station

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 3

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday launched the capital's second automated vehicle testing station at Tehkhand depot in South Delhi.

Gupta also launched 50 new electric buses, bringing the total number of buses to 6,840, of which 5,088 are electric vehicles.

"Our government is continuously working towards clean mobility; the government is working on solutions for pollution. All these steps are to make Delhi pollution-free," the chief minister said, addressing a crowd. Delhi now has the country's largest electric bus fleet; the government aims to increase the city's bus fleet to around 14,000 buses by the financial year 2028-29, she added.

The chief minister further informed that Delhi's transport department is working on the '4S model' – Safety, Sustainability, Seamless connectivity and Smart infrastructure – in the transport sector.

"We have to keep safety for the public in buses a priority; the buses that we are launching have panic buttons and CCTV cameras. The Delhi government has the target to provide much better facilities to the public," Gupta said.

The newly inaugurated automated vehicle testing station has a vehicle testing capacity of 72,000 per year. Earlier, a testing station was launched at Nand



“OUR GOVT IS CONTINUOUSLY WORKING TOWARDS CLEAN MOBILITY; THE GOVT IS WORKING ON SOLUTIONS FOR POLLUTION—CM REKHA

Nagri bus depot. "The ATS will have an annual testing capacity of 72,000 vehicles, including 52,000 heavy and light motor vehicles and 20,000 two-wheelers. The entire testing process will be automated, reducing human intervention and improving accuracy and transparency in vehicle fitness assessment," Gupta said in a statement.

The ATS will conduct essential checks including braking capacity, suspension performance, head-

light alignment, side-slip, emission levels and inspection of the underside of vehicles. Gupta noted that earlier, Delhi did not have adequate fitness testing facilities for a large number of commercial vehicles, forcing vehicle owners to travel to other parts of the national capital region for testing.

"Under the EV Policy, private vehicle owners will get several reliefs; our government is working to provide more infrastructural support like charging stations," she added.

Two new charging stations have been launched at Hassanpur and Gazipur bus depots, and both are located near the Anand Vihar bus terminal. The charging stations will expand access to EV charging infrastructure in the area and promote electric mobility.

Eight years on, one structure, no action

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 3

A glaring delay in local civic enforcement has highlighted systemic administrative inertia in South Delhi, where an unauthorised structure in Hauz Rani continues to stand despite enforcement proceedings initiated eight years ago.

Official documents from the South Delhi Municipal Corporation (SDMC) reveal that notices under Section 344(2) of the DMC Act were issued as early as January 2018 against several illegal structures in the Malviya Nagar ward. These notices cited unauthorised construction spanning ground to upper floors at properties in Hauz Rani and Khirki Village, requesting police assistance to halt work and clear illegal premises.

However, administrative records reveal that enforcement drives scheduled throughout 2018 were repeatedly deferred. Civic logs explicitly cite reasons such as "Police Force not



available" and "Shortage of Time" on over a dozen dates between March and August 2018.

Despite a recent vacation notice issued years later, the illegal building remains occupied and non-demolished. Local civil society groups have raised serious questions over the prolonged delay, requesting accountability for the lapse and a time-bound vacation drive to dismantle the structure. Resident bodies now await concrete ground action from municipal authorities.

AAP councillors disrupted MCD panel election: Mayor

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, September 3

Delhi Mayor Pravesh Wahi on Thursday accused Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) councillors of disrupting the election to the Ad Hoc Welfare of Scheduled Castes and Implementation of Scheduled Castes Candidates Quota Committee, alleging that they created a ruckus and behaved indecently with the Presiding Officer.

According to the Mayor's office, the election process commenced at the scheduled time, following which AAP councillors allegedly

entered the venue and attempted to obstruct the proceedings. Wahi said the AAP had not nominated a candidate for the election and questioned its decision to disrupt the process.

"Democracy gives everyone the right to dissent and protest, but creating a ruckus, insulting the Presiding Officer and forcibly preventing a constitutional process cannot be considered a democratic right," he said. The Mayor also alleged that AAP councillors subsequently entered his office and damaged doors and chairs.

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 3

The Delhi High Court on Thursday ruled that booth level agents of political parties cannot be held liable for false details in enumeration forms that cannot be verified during the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls.

Justice Amit Bansal said booth level agents (BLAs) are liable only for verifiable information like the elector's photograph.

"In the opinion of this court, BLA can only be made liable in terms of Section 31 of the Repre-

Delhi govt's anti-smog squad gets rolling

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 3

The Delhi government on Thursday announced a multi-tiered enforcement strategy to tackle winter air pollution, with 78 sub-divisional teams and 256 ward-level monitoring teams tasked with round-the-clock surveillance across the city.

The measures were announced by Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa after separate high-level reviews of Delhi-NCR and Delhi's preparedness for the upcoming winter pollution season.

Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav chaired a meeting on the Delhi-NCR Action Plan covering pollution-control and Information, Education and Communication

WINTER BATTLE

- » The measures were announced by Environment Minister Sirsa after separate high-level reviews of Delhi-NCR and Delhi's preparedness for the upcoming winter pollution season
- » The 78 sub-divisional teams, comprising 2 teams for each of Delhi's 39 sub-divisions, will be led by DPCC AEE/JEE-level officers
- » They will inspect biomass burning, construction dust, industrial pollution, unapproved fuels and illegal dumping...

(IEC) activities from September 2026 to March 2027. Environment ministers and senior officials from Delhi, Haryana, Punjab, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh participated virtually.

The meeting empha-

sised that air pollution is a regional challenge requiring coordinated action by Delhi and neighbouring states.

Sirsa said Delhi was strengthening enforcement through hotspot-specific and grassroots-level inter-



Delhi Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta and Assam Assembly Speaker Ranjeet Kumar Dass interact with Gen Z students of Keshav Mahavidyalaya during the Delhi Assembly's Youth Outreach Programme, in New Delhi, on Thursday

YOUNG VOICES

About 11 CP public toilets to remain open till midnight

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 3

The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC), as part of a pilot project, will extend the operating hours of 11 public toilets in Connaught Place till midnight from Friday, in a bid to make the popular commercial and leisure hub more visitor-friendly.

NDMC chairman Manoj Dwivedi said people often stay in Connaught Place till late and the timings of the public conveniences were therefore being extended.

There are 23 public toilets in Connaught Place, of which 11 will, in the first instance, remain open till midnight. Currently, all public washrooms in Connaught Place remain open till 10 pm. "People would like to be in CP till late. So from tomorrow onwards, timings for 11 public toilets are being extended up to midnight," Dwivedi said.

DELHI SPECIAL INTENSIVE REVISION

Booth level agents liable only for verifiable info in enumeration forms, rules Delhi HC

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 3

sentation of People Act for information that can be verified by the BLA, i.e., the photograph on the enumeration form matches with the identity of the elector," the judge said.

Section 31 states that making false declarations with respect to the preparation, revision or correction of an electoral roll is punishable with imprisonment for a term which may extend to one year, or with fine, or with both.

The judge passed the judgement on a petition by the Delhi Pradesh Congress Committee (DPCC) president Devender Yadav



and the chairman of the DPCC's booth management committee.

The petitioners challenged the mandate requiring BLAs of political parties to give a personal undertaking certifying they have personally verified all details in the enumeration forms.

It was argued that since the information to be filled in the enumeration form is within the elector's exclusive knowledge and the BLA's role is limited to providing assistance, he could not be made to personally authenticate all such details.

The Election Commission of India (ECI) informed the court that it permitted all registered political parties to appoint their own BLAs to participate in the process of SIR to dispel any impression of supporters of any specific party being deliberately left out by the booth level officers (BLOs)

ventions. "The approach this winter will be proactive, intensive and focused on action at the grassroots level. Our teams will maintain round-the-clock vigilance, identify pollution sources at the earliest and ensure swift action against violations," he said.

The 78 sub-divisional teams, comprising two teams for each of Delhi's 39 sub-divisions, will be led by DPCC AEE/JEE-level officers. They will inspect biomass burning, construction dust, industrial pollution, unapproved fuels and illegal dumping, including during night hours.

Another 256 ward-level teams will monitor pollution triggers 24/7, including 250 teams for MCD wards, four for NDMC areas and two for the Delhi Canton-

ment Board. The teams will also monitor construction and demolition activities through the Dust Portal, inspect decentralised C&D waste storage centres, identify unpaved roads and pothole-prone stretches, and address complaints received through the Green Delhi and 311 apps.

The government will additionally launch intensive enforcement in 48 pollution hotspots in non-conforming areas, targeting unauthorised industries involved in metal casting, powder coating, plastic reprocessing, spray painting and other polluting activities. Sirsa also stressed coordination among the DPCC, district administrations and civic agencies to ensure timely action throughout winter.

No more roads dug, AGAIN & AGAIN...

Govt okays multi-utility duct project

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, September 3

Delhi may soon see an end to the familiar cycle of roads being dug up repeatedly for laying or repairing utility lines, with the Delhi government deciding to develop multi-utility ducts (MUDs) across the city. The shared underground corridors will house essential services such as electricity cables, water and gas pipelines and fire-hydrant networks, where technically feasible.

The decision was taken at a recent Cabinet meeting, with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta calling it a major step towards creating a "safe, clean and future-ready Delhi". She said the new system would reduce repeated road excavation, minimise traffic disruption and help preserve the structural strength of roads.

"We want to create infrastructure that is safe, well-organised and sustainable, keeping future requirements in mind. The multi-utility duct is part of this vision," Gupta said.

The project will initially be rolled out on a pilot basis in Chandni Chowk, with two stretches, 310 metres on Esplanade Road and 560 metres on Mor Sarai Road, proposed for the first phase. Work on both corridors is expected to begin soon.

Based on the experience of the pilots, the government plans to expand MUDs to other parts of the capital. The system is intended to bring different utility agencies under a coordinated underground network instead of allowing separate agencies to repeatedly excavate roads for individual works.

An expert technical

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The decision was taken at a recent Cabinet meeting, with CM Rekha Gupta calling it a major step towards creating a 'safe, clean and future-ready Delhi'
- » She said the new system would reduce repeated road excavation, minimise traffic disruption and help preserve the structural strength of roads

committee will be constituted to guide the project. It will include officials and experts from discoms, the Delhi Jal Board, the Public Works Department and other departments. The committee will oversee technical planning and recommend the construction and expansion of ducts across Delhi.

The government said the ducts will incorporate provisions for ventilation, fire safety, maintenance access and emergency response. A shared underground corridor would also make maintenance and future expansion of utility networks easier while reducing the risk of accidental damage to existing lines during excavation.

Gupta said repeated excavation by different agencies was a "serious urban problem" in a rapidly developing metropolis like Delhi. "With shared underground routes available for different services through multi-utility ducts, the need to repeatedly dig up and repair roads would be significantly reduced," she said, adding that the move would minimise inconvenience to citizens and create a more coordinated and sustainable urban infrastructure system.

Court grants bail to Jain in DJB corruption case

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 3

A Delhi court on Thursday granted bail to AAP leader and former Delhi minister Satyendar Jain in a corruption case involving the Delhi Jal Board. "Bail plea is allowed," Special Judge Dig Vinay Singh said in a brief order passed orally. He directed Jain to furnish a personal bond of Rs 2 lakh along with two sureties of the like amount. A reasoned order is awaited. Jain had been sent to 14-day judicial custody on August 19. The case pertains to a tender awarded to Ms Euroteck Environmental Private Limited when Jain was the Delhi water minister.

‘PROMOTING’ ACCESS TO CHILD SEXUAL ABUSE MATERIAL

NHRC takes cognisance of paid ads on Meta platform

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 3

The NHRC has taken cognisance of reports alleging that paid advertisements displayed on a social media platform, owned and operated by Meta, promoted or facilitated access to child sexual abuse material (CSAM) in India, officials said on Thursday.

The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) has sought specific, point-wise reports within two weeks from the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting (MIB), the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) and the Delhi Police commissioner, according to the proceedings of the case dated September 3.

“MeitY shall specifically confirm compliance with Section 19 of the POCSO Act, 2012, or, in case of non-reporting, state the reasons and identify the responsible officer/authority. The above issue shall not be left to a general or omnibus response on intermediary compliance and shall be answered specifically, supported by contemporaneous records,” the pro-

ceedings said.

There was no immediate response from Meta Platforms.

“The Commission took cognisance of media reports published by the BBC World Service, alleging that paid advertisements displayed on Instagram, owned and operated by Meta Platforms Inc., promoted or facilitated access to child sexual abuse material in India,” the proceedings said.

The reported advertisements allegedly employed expressions such as “rape video” and “child video” and redirected users to channels on a messenger service where such material (CSAM/CSEA) was allegedly being offered for sale, they said.

CSEA refers to child sexual exploitation and abuse.

It was also reported that the advertisements had “passed through Meta’s review mechanism and remained accessible” despite being reported through its grievance mechanism, until specifically brought to Meta’s notice by the BBC.

“The allegations, if established, raise grave con-

CLOSER LOOK

- » There was no immediate response from Meta Platforms
- » The reported advertisements allegedly employed expressions such as ‘rape video’ and ‘child video’ and redirected users to channels on a messenger service where such material (CSAM/CSEA) was allegedly being offered for sale

cerns of online child sexual exploitation, circulation and monetisation of CSAM/CSEAM, possible organised criminal activity, and failures in intermediary due diligence, advertisement review, content moderation and child-safety mechanisms,” the proceedings said.

The complainant in the case is Namo Foundation.

The matter warrants examination under the POCSO Act, 2012, the Information Technology Act, 2000, and the applicable intermediary framework, including preservation and forensic scrutiny of electronic evidence; identification of advertisers, publishers, beneficiaries and other persons involved; tracing of financial trails; identification, rescue and rehabilitation of child victims; and determination of

responsibility of the concerned intermediaries and their officers, the proceedings said.

The Commission observed that Section 19 of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012, mandates reporting of known or apprehended offences to the special juvenile police unit or local police.

In matters involving suspected child sexual exploitation or circulation or commercial exploitation of such material, this statutory obligation cannot be substituted by internal correspondence, grievance redressal or regulatory engagement. Section 20 further prescribes specific reporting obligations, and the Act provides consequences for non-reporting, the proceedings said.

“The Commission also

takes note of the Supreme Court’s judgment in the Just Rights for Children Alliance & Anr vs S Harish & Ors case, emphasising prompt reporting, preservation of electronic evidence, coordinated investigation, identification and rescue of child victims, and statutory compliance.

The top court clarified that Section 79 of the Information Technology Act, 2000, does not, by itself, absolve non-compliance with obligations under the POCSO Act and rules, the Commission said in its proceedings.

Accordingly, it “requires examination whether Meta and other concerned persons discharged the applicable reporting obligations and took timely steps” for the preservation of evidence, reporting to law-enforcement authorities, and identification, rescue, protection and rehabilitation of child victims, it said.

In view of the foregoing, the secretary in the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology is directed to cause the matter to be examined and furnish a specific and point-wise action taken report, the NHRC

said.

In its direction to the I&B secretary, the rights panel asked “whether, where Meta itself generates, modifies, curates, recommends, publishes or amplifies content through its AI/algorithms systems, it falls within the regulatory purview of the ministry as a publisher/publisher of online curated content under the IT Rules, 2021”, and if so, the regulatory status and obligations applicable to Meta and the role or action required to be undertaken by the ministry under the existing regulatory framework.

To the Delhi Police, the NHRC said the report submitted by it pursuant to an earlier notice of the Commission is taken on record.

“The Commissioner of Police, Delhi, is granted a further period of two weeks to furnish the additional information/details sought and submit an updated action taken report, specifically indicating the action taken in the matter and the information sought/ received from Telegram, if any, along with consequential action taken thereon,” the proceedings said.



India sends additional relief supplies to Nepal

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 3

India on Thursday night dispatched its sixth tranche of over 21 tonnes of essential relief supplies on board two military transport aircraft to flood-ravaged Nepal.

The death toll from last week’s flash floods in Nepal has risen to at least 1,259 after rescue workers recovered more bodies from affected areas, according to Nepalese authorities.

While emergency teams have rescued more than 12,000 people, roughly 5,000 remain missing as search and rescue operations continue.

India has already delivered to Nepal a total of 74 tonnes of relief materials.

New Delhi had also sent a team of doctors and paramedics as well as a technical contingent along with

equipment for search and rescue operations.

“India continues humanitarian assistance to Nepal,” External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said on social media.

India dispatched two more aircraft with 21.5 tonnes of relief assistance for Nepal, including forensic kits and medical supplies, he said.

“The additional assistance will further strengthen ongoing relief and rescue efforts and support communities affected by the floods,” Jaiswal added.

The first tranche of relief materials was sent by India hours after Prime Minister Narendra Modi spoke to his Nepalese counterpart Balendra Shah on August 26, the day flash floods struck the Himalayan nation.

From page 1

Jaishankar

“India has consistently maintained that this is not an era of war, and that solutions will not emerge from the battlefield,” Jaishankar said at a joint press statement with Sybiha.

He said the conflict was causing continuing deaths and destruction and added that India was willing to contribute if its involvement could help. “If India can be of any help in any manner, we are ready,” he said. Jaishankar referred to Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s meeting with Russian President Vladimir Putin in Bishkek two days earlier, held on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit. Modi had called for the prolonged cycle of war to give way to an end to hostilities.

Sybiha welcomed Modi’s position and said Ukraine was ready to pursue diplomacy. “India is a global power and we welcome Prime Minister Modi’s call to move from an endless war towards an end to the war,” he said in a post on X.

The two foreign ministers also discussed the impact of the conflict on commercial shipping. India has been concerned about a series of attacks on merchant ships in the Black Sea in recent weeks, with Indian seafarers among those affected.

Jaishankar said disruptions to shipping were hurting countries across the Global South and contributing to shortages of fuel, fertilisers and food. He later said he had conveyed the need to ensure the “safety & security of commercial shipping and seafarers”.

He also said India had provided 19 consignments of humanitarian assistance to Ukraine since the beginning of the conflict. Education remains another area of cooperation, with many Indian students continuing to study in Ukraine. Jaishankar thanked Ukrainian authorities for taking care of them.

The minister later met Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy and briefed him on his discussions with Sybiha. “Our conversation centred on approaches to end the ongoing conflict,” Jaishankar said in a post on X.

Zelenskyy said Ukraine appreciated India’s position on ending the war. “We are grateful to India for its commitment to ending this unjust war,” he wrote, adding that “peace is needed”.

Zelenskyy also said Russia launched jet-powered Shahed drones while the Indian delegation was in Kyiv, claiming they had been developed with Iran’s assistance. According to him, Ukrainian combat aviation and fighter jets intercepted most of the drones and the Indian delegation remained safe.

Jaishankar said his visit had a bilateral purpose but was taking place amid escalating hostilities. He noted that an Indian national had been killed in an attack in Kyiv two days earlier and offered condolences to those affected. On economic ties, Jaishankar said India-Ukraine trade covered pharmaceuticals, food and agriculture, fertilisers, machinery, chemicals and consumer goods. The war and logistical problems have disrupted trade over the past four years, but he said there had been “visible resilience” and that new possibilities had emerged.

He identified digital capabilities, innovation and startups as areas with scope for greater cooperation. Artificial intelligence, he said, could open opportunities in health, education, agriculture and governance.

Sybiha said Ukraine was ready to work with India in infrastructure, pharmaceuticals, technological innovation and digitalisation. Jaishankar invited him to India for the next meeting of the Intergovernmental Commission.

Jaishankar concluded his Ukraine visit by paying homage to Mahatma Gandhi at the National Botanical Garden in Kyiv. He said Gandhi’s life and message pointed to the need to move “from endless war to the end of war”.

FCRA Bill

to submit its report to the Lok Sabha by the last day of the first week of the winter session. Nagaland Chief Minister Neiphiu Rio and Mizoram Chief Minister Lalduhoma had earlier sought a joint committee review, while Meghalaya Chief Minister Conrad K Sangma had also raised concerns with the Centre.

SC: BCI

on August 13 and subsequent modified versions to be “without any authority of law” and made its interim directions absolute.

The plea was filed by NALSAR alumni Mihira Sood and Abhishek Tiwari. BCI Chairman Manan Kumar Mishra had directed that NALSAR students not be enrolled as advocates for the time being and ordered an inquiry into the episode.

Senior advocate K Parameshwar, appearing for the students, argued that an inquiry was still required into how the directions were issued, describing the matter as one concerning freedom of speech and expression in a university. Mishra said the communications were withdrawn within an hour and that the BCI had already closed the matter.

The controversy began on August 14 when the BCI asked state bar councils to defer enrolment of NALSAR’s 2026 graduates. The CJI had earlier questioned the intervention, saying, “It’s a dialogue between students and me. Who are they (BCI) to interfere?”

Two NDMC staff killed

found the couple seriously injured. They were taken to a hospital, where doctors declared them dead.

Police said the preliminary inquiry indicated that the motorcycle slipped on the road before the Thar, which was travelling behind them, collided with and ran over the riders. The exact sequence of events is still being investigated, including road conditions and other circumstances surrounding the crash.

The couple had worked together at NDMC since 2002 and travelled to and from work together every day, according to Sukhbir’s family. His younger brother Chhotelal said he was informed about the accident by relatives and repeatedly called Sukhbir’s phone before a police officer answered and asked him to come to the police station.

Chhotelal and his nephew were later taken to Deen Dayal Upadhyay Hospital to identify Sukhbir’s body. “His jaw was completely broken, and he had injuries on his body,” he said, adding that the family understood that a Thar had hit the couple while they were turning

right. Anju’s son Rohit said the family received information about the accident around 5 pm.

Police said the Thar driver was caught by locals and handed over to them. He was identified as Bhupendra, 26, a resident of Jhajjar, Haryana, who runs a milk booth in Rohini. He was arrested and booked at Delhi Cantt police station under Sections 281 and 106(a) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita for rash driving and causing death by negligence. The case was registered as FIR No. 505/26.

Sukhbir’s brother-in-law Ramesh Pal Singh, 65, said Sukhbir had recently built a new house and was enjoying married life with Anju. He said Sukhbir was one of five siblings whose parents died when they were young, with his elder sister helping raise the family.

The family has sought government compensation and employment for Sukhbir’s younger brother in NDMC. Police said the Thar, other evidence and witness accounts are being examined as the investigation continues.

‘Preferential tariffs first,

Representative Jamieson Greer. The two-day meeting begins September 30, with the US holding the 2026 G20 presidency.

India exported goods worth about USD 87 billion to the US in 2025-26.

Goyal said India’s nine FTAs, covering economies accounting for about USD 60 trillion in GDP, would provide preferential access to nearly two-thirds of global trade. Agreements expected with Canada, Mexico, Chile, Mercosur, SACU, GCC and Israel, along with reviews of pacts with ASEAN, South Korea and Japan, could take India’s preferential access to 75 per cent of global trade in the coming years.

India already has operational trade agreements with the UK, Mauritius, Oman, UAE and Australia. A pact with New Zealand is expected to become operational soon, followed by the agreement with the 27-nation European Union.

Goyal also set a USD 1 trillion export target for the current year. Exports during April-July stood at about USD 317 billion, up from USD 280 billion in the same period last year. He said India should aim for USD 2

trillion in exports by 2030.

He called for greater use of FTAs, particularly by MSMEs and first-time exporters. States were asked to identify products and clusters where trade agreements were either delivering gains or remained underused.

Goyal said exporters would receive priority support in the proposed 100 BHAVYA industrial parks, including concessions for those committing to higher levels of exports and access to plug-and-play facilities.

Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agarwal said exporters must act within the current window before competing countries secure similar advantages. “If we miss the time window, then maybe we will miss the opportunity,” he said.

Agarwal said India trades in about 12,300 tariff lines and most are affected by existing trade agreements. He also pointed to higher quality requirements in markets such as the EU and UK, urging businesses to use the next five to 10 years to build supply chains capable of meeting those standards.

BRICS: Delhi govt offices

bilateral meetings.

As the chair this year, India will be hosting the 18th BRICS Summit at Bharat Mandapam. The summit will bring together leaders of BRICS member and partner countries as well as outreach invitees, according to the Ministry of External Affairs.

US warns

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio, speaking on The Brian Kilmeade Show on Fox News Radio on Wednesday, said countries could pursue their own foreign policies and maintain contact with Tehran, but warned that assisting Iran in generating revenue through sanctions-evasion mechanisms could invite US action.

“No country should be out there helping them create mechanisms by which they can generate revenue that they will then use to sponsor terrorism and try to build a nuclear weapon,” Rubio said.

He added that countries choosing to help Iran evade sanctions would themselves face US sanctions.

Rubio was also asked about Modi’s meeting with Pezeshkian and whether the two sides appeared to be working towards a trade

agreement. He said he did not believe India and Iran were discussing a trade deal.

“Obviously, there are countries, all develop their own foreign policy, and many countries around the world talk to the Iranian regime,” Rubio said.

He noted that Washington itself had maintained contact with elements of the Iranian regime during previous discussions.

AGENCIES

Gemini, Claude

Downdetector, reports of outages began surging in the evening (IST), with users flagging issues ranging from total website inaccessibility to internal server errors when attempting to generate AI responses.

For OpenAI, the tracking site showed a sharp spike in reports, with users noting that both ChatGPT web interface and mobile application were unresponsive. Similar patterns were observed for Google Gemini and Claude AI, where users encountered Gateway Timeout messages and failed prompts.

OpenAI’s status page acknowledged issues and elevated errors across ChatGPT and Codex.

“We have applied the mitigation and monitoring the recovery,” it said.

Anthropic said it has identified the cause of elevated errors on requests to Claude Mythos 5.1, Claude Fable 5.1, and Claude Opus 5 and is working on a fix.

It later updated that the only affected models remaining are Opus 4.8 and Opus 5. Rest of the models have recovered to the baseline error rate.

AGENCIES

WMO

could place further pressure on agriculture, health, energy and water systems.

UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres said, “The planet is in uncharted waters, and those waters are heating up.” Saulo said preparations were needed, as the event could affect communities, economies and supply chains worldwide.

The previous El Nino, in 2023-24, contributed to 2024 becoming the warmest year on record. Saulo said there was a possibility that record could be broken, with 2027 potentially seeing a temporary rise in global temperatures following the prolonged event.

‘2 brothers die after being treated by quack in Jharkhand, mother critical’

MPOST BUREAU
Ramgarh, September 3

Two brothers, who were allegedly being treated by a local quack for fever, died on Thursday in Jharkhand’s Ramgarh district, while their mother was referred to a hospital in Ranchi in critical condition, a senior official said.

The three members of the family had been suffering from fever for the past three days in a village under Patratu block, officials said.

Instead of consulting a doctor or visiting a hospital, the family allegedly sought treatment from an ‘ojha guni’, or sorcerer and traditional healer, they said.

The condition of the two brothers, aged 10 and 15, deteriorated, and they were taken to Sadar Hospital, where they died one after another, officials said.

Their mother was also admitted to the hospital and later referred to the Rajendra Institute of Medical Sciences (RIMS) in Ranchi in critical condition.

On receiving information about the deaths, local police and administrative officials reached the spot.

District Civil Surgeon Dr Anil Kumar said the family members, including the two brothers and their mother, had been suffering from fever for three days but approached an ‘ojha guni’ for treatment instead of consulting a qualified doctor or visiting a hospital.

“Their condition turned critical, and they were brought to Sadar Hospital, where the two brothers died, while their mother has been referred to Ranchi in critical condition,” Kumar said.

“We have ordered an inquiry into the deaths. A medical team will visit the spot to ascertain the nature of the fever,” he said.

Kumar declined to confirm the exact nature of the fever but expressed apprehension that it could be a case of swine flu.

Officials appealed to villagers not to fall prey to superstition and to take patients to the nearest health centre or hospital in case of illness.

INDIA, BELGIUM AGREE TO DOUBLE TRADE

PM Modi: India's economic growth 'source of confidence' for the world

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 3

India and Belgium on Thursday agreed to expand defence cooperation by signing a range of pacts, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi and his Belgian counterpart Bart De Wever identifying trade and investment, critical minerals, high technologies, and semiconductors as key drivers to bolster ties in the face of a fragmented global geopolitical environment.

After wide-ranging talks between the two leaders, Modi highlighted India's 7.8 per cent economic growth in the last quarter and framed the country's rise as a source of confidence and new opportunities for the world. The two countries inked five agreements, including one on boosting defence ties and another on the renewable energy sector, besides setting a target of doubling the volume of annual bilateral trade in the next five years.

At present, the two-way trade stands at USD 13 billion. An Investment Fast-Track Mechanism is being set up to promote Belgian investments in India. A separate Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) was signed between the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) and the Belgian Federal Police on cooperation in combating transnational organised crime, cyber-crime and related matters. "Today, the world is



PM Narendra Modi with Belgium PM Bart De Wever during a joint press statement, at Hyderabad House in New Delhi, Thursday

HIGHLIGHTS

» The two countries inked 5 pacts, including one on boosting defence ties and another on renewable energy

» They also set a target of doubling the volume of annual bilateral trade in the next five years

going through a period of great upheaval. Conflicts continue to persist in many parts of the world. Whether it is food, fuel, or supply chains, every sector is being impacted by uncertainty," Modi said.

"In this challenging environment, India's economy has maintained its momentum. We recorded 7.8 per cent growth in the last quarter. Today, India's growth story is becoming a source of confidence and new opportunities for the world," he added.

The Belgian prime minister described the conclu-

sion of the India-European Union free trade pact as a major milestone and said New Delhi and Brussels are building a relationship that is broad and more strategic than ever before.

De Wever said Belgium wants to take ties with India to "another level – economically, politically, but also strategically".

"We live in a more fragmented and uncertain world. We talked about this a lot. Prosperity and security increasingly go hand in hand, and our relationship has already deep roots," he said.

While underlining the importance of boosting trade, the two leaders called for timely implementation of the India-European Union free trade agreement to realise the true potential of business and investment collaboration.

The two prime ministers, delving into pressing geo-political issues, called for resolution of the conflicts in Ukraine and West Asia through dialogue and diplomacy, in accordance with the principles of the UN Charter and international law.

On the margins of the Modi-De Wever talks, 10 agreements on collaboration between the Belgian and Indian defence industry were signed. Some of the pacts will provide for joint production of military hardware, using Belgian military technology, such as rockets in India.

In line with the deepening defence ties, New Delhi announced the appointment of a resident defence attache at its embassy in Brussels. A decision was also made to soon conclude a migration and mobility agreement.

A joint statement said Modi and De Wever welcomed the steady expansion of bilateral economic ties and the growing diversification of sectors in bilateral trade, and expressed their determination to further strengthen cooperation across key sectors of shared interest.

CEO appointment 'reignites' Ram Temple donation theft row; accountability sought

Oppn leaders question trust's earlier financial management

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, September 3

The appointment of retired Air Marshal Jeetendra Mishra as the first CEO of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust has triggered a political controversy, with Opposition leaders questioning the trust's earlier financial management and demanding accountability over an alleged temple donation theft case.

Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav questioned why employees arrested in the alleged case remained in custody while senior figures were given clean chits following a Special Investigation Team (SIT) probe.

"If the big people have got a clean chit, then why are the small employees still in jail? Get them released

CEO-elect attends first meeting

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Ayodhya, September 3

Retired Air Marshal Jeetendra Mishra, appointed as the first Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust, attended his first meeting with the trust in Ayodhya on Thursday but is yet to formally assume charge. Mishra arrived in

Ayodhya in the morning, offered prayers at the Ram temple and later attended the meeting with trust members. He said he would spend the next two to five days understanding the trust's functioning before formally taking charge.

The meeting covered the trust's administration, financial management, accounts and accounting procedures.

too," Yadav said in Saharanpur. He alleged that the controversy had hurt devotees' sentiments and questioned the sequence of arrests and subsequent clean chits. Congress leader Arad-

hana Mishra said the issue involved offerings made by devotees and questioned the action taken after the SIT investigation. Congress leader Nana Patole also opposed the appointment of

Cong questions GDP data

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 3

The Congress on Thursday challenged the Narendra Modi government's reported 7.8 per cent GDP growth in the April-June 2026 quarter, alleging that systematic revisions and methodological changes had inflated growth figures over the past four years.

Congress leader Jairam Ramesh said the headline growth figure appeared questionable when the underlying calculations were examined. He alleged that the government had revised the April-June 2025

GDP base from Rs 86 lakh crore to Rs 80 lakh crore, thereby increasing the year-on-year growth rate.

Citing calculations by former Finance Secretary Subhash Chandra Garg, Ramesh claimed that without the downward revision, nominal growth would have been 2.6 per cent instead of 10.3 per cent, translating into near-zero real growth after accounting for inflation.

He said cumulative downward revisions over four financial years amounted to Rs 43 lakh crore and demanded an explanation from the

government. Ramesh also questioned the GDP deflator of 2.5 per cent against retail inflation of 3.9 per cent and wholesale inflation of 9.4 per cent.

He cited data indicating a 5.2 per cent contraction in manufacturing GVA and a 5.4 per cent decline in private consumption. The HSBC Purchasing Managers' Index, he said, fell to a five-year low in August.

Ramesh also cited concerns raised by former Chief Economic Adviser Arvind Subramanian over growth estimates and the IMF's "C" rating for India's national accounts in late 2025.

Himachal Dy CM meets Gadkari, attends summit on water security

ASHWANI SHARMA
Shimla, September 3

Himachal Pradesh Deputy Chief Minister Mukesh Agnihotri on Thursday raised several issues concerning the state's transport and tourism sectors during a meeting with Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari, including a request to extend the permissible age of contract-carriage vehicles from 12 to 15 years.

Agnihotri pointed out that the operational age limit for vehicles covered under the All India Tourist Permit (AITP) scheme had already been extended and sought similar relaxation for contract-carriage vehicles operating within Himachal Pradesh. He stressed that the extension should be implemented without compromising road safety.

Following the discussion, a decision was taken to extend the validity period of taxis operating within the state under tourist permits from 12 years to 15 years.

Gadkari directed that the required notification be issued in this regard.

Agnihotri also highlighted the shortage of Automated Testing Stations (ATS) in Himachal Pradesh, saying only two such centres were currently functional. He requested that the existing manual fitness-testing system be allowed to continue alongside automated testing until sufficient ATS infrastructure becomes operational across the state.

Gadkari assured the Deputy Chief Minister that the state government's request would be considered sympathetically and sought details on the status of ATS facilities currently under construction.

Agnihotri also sought intervention for connecting the Amritsar-Hoshiarpur National Highway with the highway network between Pandoga, near the Punjab-Himachal border, and Jhalera in Una district. Necessary instructions were issued on the request, according to the

state government.

Later in the day, Agnihotri attended the concluding session of the two-day National Departmental Water Security Summit organised by the Ministry of Jal Shakti and chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The summit deliberated on water security, conservation, drinking water supply, efficient management of water resources and the use of modern technology. Speaking at the summit, Agnihotri said water conservation was among the country's key priorities, particularly amid climate change and changing weather patterns. He said Himachal Pradesh needed to protect its natural water sources, strengthen drinking water schemes and adopt scientific and sustainable methods for managing water resources.

He called for greater participation of local communities in conservation efforts and urged that water conservation be turned into a people's movement.

Briefs

UP: 26 doctors sacked

LUCKNOW: Twenty-six doctors posted at government hospitals and health centres across Uttar Pradesh have been dismissed for prolonged absence and alleged negligence in duty, officials said. Departmental proceedings have also been ordered against nine other doctors for disobeying senior officials and neglecting medical responsibilities. Deputy CM Brajesh Pathak directed regular monitoring of doctors' attendance and patient services.

Contempt case: Relief to YouTuber

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Thursday suspended the six-month jail sentence imposed on YouTuber Gulshan Pahuja for criminal contempt over videos that allegedly attacked judicial officers and lowered the judiciary's dignity.

CJP's Ranka meets Akhilesh

LUCKNOW: National spokesperson of the CJP Ashutosh Ranka met Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav in Lucknow on Thursday. SP's chief spokesperson Rajendra Chaudhary confirmed that Ranka and Yadav met in the state capital on Thursday evening. He, however, said he did not have details of the issues discussed during the meeting.

Kharge urges Nadda to ensure FIR over Haldwani 'purification' row

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 3

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge has urged Rajya Sabha Leader of the House J P Nadda to direct Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami to ensure registration of an FIR against those allegedly involved in the "purification" of a rally venue in Haldwani, describing the incident as an act of "untouchability".

In a letter to Nadda, Kharge recalled raising the issue in the Rajya Sabha on August 13, following his public meeting at Ramlila Maidan in Haldwani on August 8. He said Nadda had then assured the House that the incident would be investigated and strict action taken against those found guilty.

Kharge said Rajya Sabha Chairman C P Radhakrishnan had also expressed grief over the incident. However, he expressed surprise that 24 days after the incident,

KHARGE SAID RS CHAIRMAN RADHAKRISHNAN HAD ALSO EXPRESSED GRIEF OVER THE INCIDENT

no FIR had been registered against the organisations or individuals allegedly responsible.

"The most objectionable aspect of this incident was that at the Ramlila Maidan site where I addressed the rally, purification was carried out, contrary to the spirit of the Indian Constitution and human values," Kharge said in the letter dated September 2.

He argued that such a ritual was directly linked to untouchability and cited the Mahad movement led by B R Ambedkar, saying a similar "purification" had been carried out after Ambedkar drank water from a public tank.

Kharge said the issue went beyond him or the

Congress and concerned millions of people facing caste discrimination. He urged Nadda to ensure that an FIR was registered against those responsible in accordance with the assurances given in Parliament.

Speaking to reporters later, Kharge said the incident was not merely about purification but reflected a mindset of claiming superiority over a particular section of society. He said the Congress would approach the Rajya Sabha chairman over the matter.

Kharge also criticised Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah for their silence on the issue, alleging that the BJP remained silent whenever incidents involving Dalits occurred.

He defended Rahul Gandhi, who had earlier criticised the alleged purification and demanded an FIR under the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act.

APEX COURT FLAGS HIGHWAY ENCROACHMENTS

Why can't CCTV be installed at toll plazas, SC asks NHAI

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 3

The Supreme Court on Thursday flagged the issue of encroachment and stationary vehicles on highways and asked the National Highways Authority of India why it cannot install a camera surveillance system and monitoring rooms across toll plazas to deal with it.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta, which was hearing a suo motu case related to an accident in Rajasthan's Phalodi area that claimed 15 lives, said that encroachment and stationary vehi-



cles on highways were the two major issues.

The counsel appearing for the NHAI said they have issued circulars for regular inspection and patrolling to check unauthorised parking on the highways.

KEY POINTS

» The bench was hearing a suo motu case related to an accident in Rajasthan's Phalodi area that claimed 15 lives

» 'Why can't you think of having a camera surveillance system? You can have monitoring rooms at all toll plazas,' it said

» Senior advocate ANS Nadkarni said one of the major issues was illegal parking of vehicles on highways, which leads to road accidents

"Why can't you think of having a camera surveillance system? You can have monitoring rooms at all toll plazas," the bench said.

Senior advocate ANS Nadkarni, who is assisting the top court as an amicus

curiae in the matter, said one of the major issues was illegal parking of vehicles on highways, which leads to road accidents.

The bench noted that the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways, the

Ministry of Home Affairs and the Tamil Nadu government have not yet filed their compliance affidavits in the matter.

It granted two weeks to both the ministries to file their affidavits.

The bench posted the matter for October 6 and directed the Tamil Nadu government to file an affidavit before the next date of hearing.

In November last year, the top court took suo motu cognisance of the November 2 road accident in Phalodi in which a tempo traveller rammed into a stationary trailer truck.

The incident occurred near Matoda village on the Bharat Mala Highway when the tempo traveller was going from Bikaner's Kolayat temple to Jodhpur.

On April 13, the top court issued a slew of interim directions, including that no heavy or commercial vehicle shall park or stop on any national highway carriageway or paved shoulder except at a designated bay, lay-bye or wayside amenity.

It had also prohibited construction/operation of any new 'dhaba', eatery, or commercial structure within the right of way of any national highway.

a CEO, arguing that the temple administration should be guided by saints and seers.

SP Rajya Sabha MP Ramjilal Suman sought an inquiry by a sitting Supreme Court judge or a joint parliamentary committee, alleging that the SIT had failed to establish accountability.

NCP (Sharadchandra Pawar) spokesperson Anish Gawande also questioned Mishra's appointment and raised allegations concerning the trust's previous management. The appointment also drew criticism from religious quarters. Jagatguru Balak Das Devacharya Maharaj of Patalpuri Math in Varanasi said religious institutions should function under the guidance of saints and seers, though administrators could handle operational responsibilities.

Akash needs more political maturity, says BSP supremo

MPOST BUREAU
Lucknow, September 3

Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) chief Mayawati on Thursday said her nephew Akash Anand needs to become more politically mature and decided against entrusting him with any major role in the party.

"I have allowed Akash Anand to work in the party, which is before all of you, but Akash Anand still needs to become more mature. Till then, it would not be appropriate to give him a major responsibility in the party," she said, addressing a national level meeting of BSP office-bearers here. The former Uttar Pradesh chief minister also announced that her party has decided to contest all elections across the country -- however big or small -- on its own, terming the Congress "strongly anti-Dalit and anti-Ambedkar".

Additionally, citing the remarks made by RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat during his recent US visit, the BSP supremo lashed out at the Rashtriya Swayam-sevak Sangh (RSS), saying the organisation lacked credibility as there was a wide gap between its words and actions.

Bhagwat, during his recent visit to the United States, said if a Hindu believes there should be no Muslims in Bharat, "he will not remain Hindu". He also stressed that Hindu philosophy accepts that different faiths can lead to the same truth, emphasising unity in diversity.

LANDSLIDES HIT HIMACHAL; FLOOD ALERTS IN BENGAL

Heavy rains kill 5 in UP, push Ganga River towards danger mark in Bihar

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 3

Heavy rains disrupted normal life across several states on Thursday, claiming five lives in Uttar Pradesh, pushing the Ganga towards its highest flood mark in Bihar, triggering landslides in Himachal Pradesh and affecting road and rail services in West Bengal.

In Uttar Pradesh, five people were killed in separate rain-related incidents in Chitrakoot, Amethi and Barabanki. In Chitrakoot, a mud house collapsed in Barachhi village, killing a 32-year-old man and his two children, aged five and one. His wife and daughter were injured. A 66-year-old man died after a mud wall collapsed in Amethi, while another man was killed and his son-in-law injured in a similar incident in Barabanki. The district is among 23 flood-affected districts.

In Bihar, authorities stepped up vigilance as the Ganga was expected to cross its highest flood mark at Patna's Gandhi Ghat on Thursday night. Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary inspected the rising water level and directed officials to ensure public safety. The river is also likely to cross the mark at Hathidah in Mokama around noon on September 4.

In Himachal Pradesh, debris disrupted traf-



A woman carrying her belongings waded through a waterlogged area in Patna, Thursday

PTI

PM reviews Varanasi flood situation

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Varanasi, September 3

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday spoke to Varanasi District Magistrate Satyendra Kumar over the phone and reviewed the flood situation in the city, including the rising Ganga water level, affected areas and relief camp arrangements.

Modi, who represents Varanasi in the Lok Sabha, directed the administration to ensure that flood-

affected residents face no difficulties and that relief and rescue operations are conducted on a war footing.

He sought details of food, drinking water and other essential facilities being provided at relief camps and instructed officials to arrange additional relief material wherever required. He also stressed continuous monitoring of the situation and timely delivery of assistance to affected people.

The Ganga reached 70.42 metres at 4 pm on Thursday, around 16 cm above the warning level of 70.262 metres, raising concerns in low-lying areas.

At Assi Ghat, nearly five feet of water accumulated over the Subah-e-Banaras platform, prompting authorities to barricade the area and stop public entry. Water has also started approaching the road from the old Assi Ghat side.

closed. Bilaspur's Naina Devi recorded the highest rainfall at 130.6 mm.

In West Bengal, the Damodar Valley Corporation issued flood alerts after releasing water from Maithon and Panchet reservoirs. Five districts, including Purba Bardhaman and Howrah, were put on alert.

Rail services on the Eastern Railway's Howrah-Malda division were also affected after heavy rain eroded soil beneath tracks between Tilpara and New Farakka.

Several long-distance trains were delayed, while north Bengal-bound services were diverted through a bypass route.

Briefs

UP: Elderly man held for raping minor

BALLIA: A 75-year-old man was arrested on Thursday for allegedly raping a minor girl in Uttar Pradesh's Ballia. The incident happened on Wednesday when the man "lured the 10-year-old girl, a resident of his neighbourhood, to a secluded spot where he allegedly raped her". Based on a complaint by the girl's mother, a case was registered.

Assam: 4 held with Rs 6.6-cr drugs

GUWAHATI: Four suspected drug traffickers were arrested in Assam's Sribhumdi district with 66,000 Yaba tablets worth Rs 6.6 crore, Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma said. Police intercepted a vehicle and recovered the tablets concealed beneath the driver's seat. Sarma praised the action.

Assam: 2 'thieves' killed...

GUWAHATI: Two suspected vehicle thieves were killed in a police encounter in Assam's Kamrup Metropolitan district on Thursday after a chase. Police said the suspects opened fire after their vehicle crashed at a check-point. Two pistols, mobile phones and vehicle-theft equipment were recovered.

'Pb ready for salary parity with Centre'

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 3

Punjab Finance Minister Harpal Singh Cheema on Thursday said the state government was ready to ensure salary and dearness allowance (DA) parity with Central government employees if that was what its employees wanted, while stressing that the overall compensation package, rather than only the DA rate, should be considered.

Cheema, accompanied by Industries and Commerce Minister Aman Arora and Social Security Minister Baljit Kaur, accused the opposition of misleading employees and pensioners over the DA issue. He claimed Punjab government employees in several categories already receive higher take-home salaries than their Central counterparts and said the state pays among the highest salaries in the country. The ministers' remarks

came days after the Punjab government approached the Supreme Court against a High Court order directing it to release pending DA and dearness relief dues, estimated at around Rs 14,191 crore, within a fortnight.

Cheema blamed previous governments for leaving around Rs 14,000 crore in arrears and said the AAP government had cleared Rs 4,500 crore. He said DA was increased from 28 per cent when the government assumed office to 34 per cent in October 2022, 38 per cent in December 2023 and 42 per cent in 2024.

Arora said raising DA to 60 per cent would impose an additional annual burden of about Rs 6,500 crore on the state exchequer.

He urged employee unions to resolve outstanding issues through dialogue, saying the government's finances also had to support schools, hospitals and infrastructure.

Ladakh L-G visits historic border village, envisions it as major tourism destination



MPOST BUREAU
Leh, September 3

Ladakh Lieutenant Governor VK Saxena on Thursday visited Hunderman village, one of India's northernmost settlements adjoining the Line of Control (LoC) in Kargil, and reviewed efforts to develop it as a major border and heritage tourism destination.

Saxena was briefed on the "Exploring LoC and Hunderman Village Experience" project, which includes an LoC viewpoint, integrated amenity centre, information pan-

els, walking promenade, landscaping, cafes, eateries and other visitor facilities. He directed officials to complete the development works by the end of October.

Located about 10 km north of Kargil on the banks of the Suru river, Hunderman remained under Pakistan's control until the 1971 Indo-Pak war, when the Indian Army captured surrounding heights and brought the area under Indian control.

"Hunderman is not merely a border village; it is a living symbol of Ladakh's history, heritage and

Centre reviews Himalayan states' preparedness against avalanches

Union Home Secy chairs meeting on GLOFs, avalanches

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 3

INSIGHT

- » The meeting discussed the growing threat posed by GLOFs
- » Officials deliberated on identifying high-risk locations, timely dissemination of alerts, and evacuation preparedness

Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan on Thursday chaired a meeting to review preparedness of Himalayan states and Jammu and Kashmir against Glacial Lake Outburst Floods (GLOFs) and snow avalanches, with a focus on strengthening early warning and response mechanisms.

Chief Secretaries and State Disaster Management Authorities of Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh, along with officials from Jammu and Kashmir, participated in the meeting. Senior officials from the Ministry of Home Affairs, National Disaster Management Authority, Central Water Commission, India Meteorological Department and Defence Geoinformatics Research Establishment also attended.

The meeting discussed the growing threat posed by GLOFs in the Himalayan region and the need for continuous monitoring of potentially dangerous glacial lakes and avalanche-prone areas. Officials also deliberated on identifying high-risk locations and flow paths, timely dissemination of alerts, evacuation preparedness and strengthening response capabilities.

The states and the Union Territory outlined mea-

sures undertaken to monitor vulnerable glacial lakes, improve early warning systems and ensure last-mile dissemination of alerts. Community preparedness, flow-path planning and mobilisation of response resources in vulnerable areas were also discussed.

Mohan stressed that mitigation measures must translate into action at the district and local levels, particularly in areas vulnerable to GLOFs and avalanches. He called for proactive monitoring during high-risk periods and close coordination among state agencies, district administrations and scientific and technical institutions.

He said preparedness should extend beyond emergency response to include risk-informed planning, preventive mitigation and community participation.

ED conducts multiple raids in 4 states

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, September 3

The Enforcement Directorate (ED) on Thursday conducted searches at multiple locations in Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Telangana and Kerala under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) in cases involving suspected laundering of proceeds generated through illicit narcotics trafficking.

In Tamil Nadu, searches were conducted in four

cases linked to methamphetamine trafficking and alleged hawala transactions. In the Nisardeen-Kasilingam case, the ED searched premises in Chennai and Ramanathapuram.

Searches in the Syed Ibrahim case followed the seizure of 5.97 kg methamphetamine, Rs 39.38 lakh cash, 586 gm gold and 1 kg silver.

Six locations each were searched in Chennai in the Udaya Kumar case and Nagapattinam and Velankanni

in the M Alex case, involving alleged hawala transactions and investments of drug proceeds.

In Karnataka, three locations linked to habitual offender Mruthyunjaya were searched.

Three locations were searched in Telangana in a ganja trafficking case involving Kalapathi Nithu Bai and others, while four premises were searched in Kerala in cases linked to hybrid ganja and MDMA trafficking networks.

Saini seeks stronger Hry-Punjab bond

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, September 3

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday paid obeisance at Gurdwara Sri Katalgarh Sahib in Chamkaur Sahib, Punjab, and prayed for the prosperity of Haryana's people and stronger bonds of brotherhood between Haryana and Punjab.

AT CHAMKAUR SAHIB, HE ANNOUNCED RS 21L FOR THE CONSTRUCTION OF 'BIBI SHARAN KAUR GATE'

Saini announced Rs 21 lakh for the construction of a historic gate to be named after Amar Shaheed Bibi Sharan Kaur, who performed the last rites of Sahibzadas Baba Ajit Singh and Baba Jujhar Singh following their martyrdom in 1704.

Addressing the Sangat, Saini described Chamkaur Sahib as a symbol of sacrifice, courage, service and resilience. He said Bibi Sharan Kaur's valour and selfless service demonstrated that women have always played a significant role in serving society and defending its values.

The Chief Minister said the younger generation should be taught the history and sacrifices of the Sikh Gurus and martyrs. He also highlighted initiatives by the Haryana government, including a Rs 100-crore Sikh Museum in Kurukshetra to spread the teachings of the Gurus.

Saini said his government had fulfilled 70 of its 217 election commitments within one-and-a-half years. He said Rs 2,000 crore had been transferred to women's accounts under the proposed Rs 2,100 monthly assistance scheme.

INDIA'S VISION FOR NEXT DECADE

Govt unveils strategic blueprint on defence diplomacy

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 3

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Thursday released 'Raksha' - a strategic blueprint on defence diplomacy which carries a "comprehensive framework" outlining India's strategic roadmap and vision for global partnerships over the next decade.

"As defence diplomacy is a core pillar of India's foreign policy, this document provides a clear, actionable vision for the next decade, ensuring that India remains an anchor of peace, stability, and rule-based order in an evol-



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh during the release of 'RAKSHA' document

ving global landscape," the defence ministry said.

The document marks a shift in India's strategic engagement, aligning national security objectives with proactive global cooperation, fostering long-term stability and mutual growth, it said.

Singh released the 'Raksha' document on defence diplomacy in New Delhi.

Key pillars highlighted in the strategic blueprint include, strategic partnerships, capacity building, indigenous exports and maritime security.

Under the pillar 'stra-

tegic partnerships', the vision seeks to deepen bilateral and multilateral security cooperation.

Enhancing joint military exercises, training programmes, and sharing best practices with friendly nations is the vision under the pillar of 'capacity build-

ing'. The other two pillars: 'indigenous exports' -- seek to promote Make-in-India defence platforms to establish the nation as a reliable global defence manufacturing hub; and 'maritime security' -- seek to strengthen India's role as a net-security provider

KEY POINTS

- » Rajnath Singh released the 'Raksha' document on defence diplomacy in New Delhi
- » This comprehensive framework outlines India's strategic roadmap and vision for global defence partnerships over the next 10 years

PTI

EDITORIAL

Beyond Judicial Correction

The Supreme Court’s decision to quash criminal cases arising from student protests over the NEET controversy raises a question extending far beyond one examination: who is accountable when criminal law is invoked against citizens without sufficient justification? Courts can eventually strike down an FIR, but judicial relief cannot erase everything preceding it. For a student, merely being named in a criminal case can mean visits to police stations and courts, legal expenses, anxiety over education and employment, and the stigma of being treated as an accused. The process itself can consequently become punishment even when prosecution ultimately leads nowhere. This becomes particularly troubling when criminal law enters spaces of peaceful protest. Students have every right to question institutions, demand transparency and demonstrate against decisions affecting their futures, provided their actions remain within the law. Disagreement, sloganeering or participation in peaceful demonstrations cannot automatically be treated as conduct deserving criminal prosecution. Democracy requires authorities to distinguish between dissent that is inconvenient and conduct that is genuinely unlawful.

That distinction becomes meaningless if there are no consequences for getting it wrong. An FIR may represent only the beginning of an investigation, but its consequences are hardly preliminary for the person named in it. Once criminal law begins moving, an individual can face investigation, possible arrest, bail proceedings and prolonged uncertainty. The imbalance becomes particularly stark when students confront the power of the State. Quashing an unjustified FIR therefore repairs only part of the damage. Institutional accountability must accompany judicial correction. This does not mean police officers should face punishment whenever a court disagrees with an investigation; policing frequently requires difficult decisions. But meaningful scrutiny is necessary where courts find that basic ingredients of an alleged offence were absent, criminal provisions were disproportionately applied, or prosecution appeared primarily intended to suppress legitimate expression. Senior officers should review questionable cases, departments should examine repeated misuse of provisions, and governments should establish safeguards for handling student demonstrations. Where deliberate or reckless misuse is established, responsibility must be fixed.

Criminal law must remain an instrument of justice, not administrative convenience. India does not lack provisions to deal with violence, destruction of property, intimidation or genuine threats to public order. Those committing such acts must face lawful consequences. But stretching criminality to encompass peaceful opposition weakens public confidence in institutions meant to enforce the law impartially. Universities and examination systems are particularly sensitive environments: young citizens confronting perceived unfairness should encounter mechanisms for dialogue and grievance redressal before encountering police cases. Courts remain an essential constitutional safeguard when executive action crosses legal boundaries, but judicial intervention should be the last defence, not the routine mechanism for correcting avoidable excesses. The lesson from the NEET protest cases must therefore extend beyond celebrating their quashing. A justice system should ask not only whether an unjustified prosecution can eventually be stopped, but why it was allowed to begin. Until institutions are required to answer that question, wrongful FIRs will continue imposing penalties long before any court determines whether a crime was ever committed.

LETTER



letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Digital Danger

The growing threat from malicious mobile applications should concern every smartphone user. Apps seeking unnecessary permissions can expose personal data, financial information and private communications. Users must verify applications before installation, avoid suspicious links and regularly review permissions. Stronger digital awareness is now essential to keeping smartphones and personal information secure.

SANJAY GUPTA,
NOIDA

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Ancient Bonds for Modern Diplomacy

From Buddhist heritage and Ayurveda to shared epics, PM Modi’s Central Asia engagement places civilisational diplomacy alongside strategic cooperation

CIVILISATIONAL OUTREACH



ANIRBAN GANGULY

THE WRITER IS MEMBER NEC, BJP & CHAIRMAN, DR SYAMA PRASAD MOOKERJEE RESEARCH FOUNDATION

Soft power forms a crucial stream in Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s seven-streamed – *Saptadhara* – roadmap for civilisational India’s rise. His just-concluded Central Asia visit to Uzbekistan and Kyrgyzstan and his address at the SCO Summit in Bishkek have reaffirmed the centrality of that stream.

From steadily recovering India’s stolen artefacts, to recovering her Buddhist heritage and legacy, to reinstating legacies such as the Cholas and Somnath, from Prambanan’s Trimurti Temples to Gandan’s sacred Buddhist monastery, from Buddha Relics yatras to Samvad, PM Modi has consistently made creative efforts to reconnect India’s civilisational footprints across the world with civilisations and people who have enriched those linkages and made them enduring ones.

The India-Central Asia civilisational connection and linkage has been intense and rich. Saivism, Buddhism, Buddhist Viharas and Hindu temples dotted this vast landscape in the past. Art historian and scholar of Buddhism P Banerjee, in his “Hindu Deities in Central Asia”, speaks of the “Narayana cult” in Central Asia.



PM Modi has given India’s soft power a deeper civilisational dimension

He refers to the Russian archaeologist and orientalist A.N. Bernstam, who discovered a fragment of an inscription in Kharosthi, which, when translated, read, “Narayana, be victorious.” Viharas and temples, Indian medicine and Ayurveda were among the principal exports, so to say, to Central Asia.

As PM Modi inked the collaboration agreement in Traditional Medicine – Ayurveda and Uzbek medicinal herbs – one was reminded of the words of the legendary French writer, linguist and historian Jean Filliozat. In an essay on the “Expansion of Indian Medicine Abroad”, Filliozat argued that in civilisational India’s exchanges and interactions with Central Asia, China, Indo-China, Indonesia and beyond the seas, “Indian Ayurvedic medicine has been one of the main matters of export, along with astronomy, religions and arts.” A prolific scholar and admirer of civilisational India, Filliozat wrote of the sands of Central Asia yielding

SOFT POWER REMAINS CENTRAL TO INDIA’S CIVILISATIONAL ROADMAP

“not only Buddhist texts and documents of archives in Sanskrit, or Prakrit, but also medicinal manuscripts in Sanskrit, or translated from Sanskrit” into the languages of the region.

India’s commitment to preserving Uzbekistan’s Buddhist heritage is another major step in renewing the civilisational link. Central Asia, in the past, formed an important incubation cradle for Buddhism. Well-known Russian historian and Central Asia expert B.A. Litvinsky concluded that, with new discoveries made every year, it was established that “Buddhism was supreme” in “Central Asia for centuries

together.” For India, under Modi, Uzbekistan’s Buddhist heritage was a joint civilisational heritage.

While PM Modi firmed up pacts and collaborative ventures in Artificial Intelligence, critical minerals, clean energy and nuclear energy, the underlying texture of the visit was the renewal of civilisational bonds.

It was seen in the Kyrgyz mega-epic *Manas*’ connection with the *Mahabharata*. Its essence had been absorbed when Kyrgyz scholars spoke of the common civilisational values that the two mega-epics shared. A civilisational dialogue can also be reflected through a Dialogue of Epics. Major epics of enduring civilisations speak. They radiate core cultural, societal and spiritual values, and a dialogue best serves to re-establish civilisational commonalities.

It shone through when PM Modi discussed the essence and civilisational wisdom of *Thirukkural* in Tashkent and spoke of its spirituality, philosophy and prac-

tical wisdom, and of how it offers insights into one of the oldest languages of humanity. His suggestion that *Thirukkural* could be translated into the Uzbek language stemmed from India’s essential belief that her civilisational wisdom was meant for the well-being of the world.

PM Modi’s suggestion reminded me of the words of a formidable scholar of civilisational India, Suniti Kumar Chatterji, who spoke of how ancient India, having “obtained for herself the means for the realisation of truth, and having obtained it”, moved in a “spirit of joyful participation” into “countries known and unknown and gave of her treasure to the nations.”

PM Modi’s participation in the 6th edition of the World Nomad Games, with India sending its biggest contingent of 87 members, underlined India’s commitment to these uniquely creative civilisational initiatives.

The Bishkek SCO Declaration carried a number of India-led initiatives and suggestions – *the Civilisational Dialogue Forum, Young Scientist Forum* and the *Young Authors’ Conclave*. Each one is a defining and future-oriented suggestion that can shape and crystallise ideas and initiatives, especially among the young intelligentsia in this region.

PM Modi’s underscoring that “India would be delighted to host the first edition of the SCO Civilisational Dialogue Forum, later this year” is certainly one of the high points of the visit. With her past civilisational linkages in the SCO region and her philosophy of “*Dharma-Vijaya*”, the inaugural edition of the Dialogue in India will be a significant first step in institutionalising this first-of-its-kind Dialogue.

This edition of PM Modi’s Central Asia visit and SCO engagement, thus, has been a refreshing one, auguring possibilities that are inspired and driven by the seventh stream of his “*Saptadhara*” vision.

Views expressed are personal

China’s Growing Water Leverage

Nepal’s catastrophe exposes growing risks from China’s control over transboundary Asian rivers

HYDRO POLITICS



DIPANKAR DEY

THE WRITER IS A PROFESSOR OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

On August 26, devastating flash floods struck Nepal, which – according to preliminary reports – were triggered by an avalanche of ice and rocks near the Nepal-Tibet border. As of Thursday, the death toll in Nepal stood at 1,252, while 4,216 people remained missing or out of contact, according to Nepal’s National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA). In neighbouring Tibet, Chinese authorities have reported 21 deaths and 541 people missing, taking the combined toll to 1,273 dead and 4,757 missing. Rescuers are rushing to find flood survivors trapped inside hydro-power tunnels, with around 900 workers still unaccounted for.

In more than seven decades of glacial lake outbursts, monsoon cloudbursts and Koshi embankment failures, the August 26 disaster is the latest and dead-

liest flood disaster in a generation. Between 1954 and August 26, 2026, more than 100 flood-related disasters have been recorded in Nepal.

Last year, in July 2025, a supraglacial lake roughly 36 kilometres north of the Nepal-China border, at an altitude of around 5,150 metres, drained suddenly, sending a flash flood down the Lhende stream into Nepal’s Rasuwa district. Roughly a month after the July 8 disaster, China and Nepal publicly agreed in principle to share cross-border information on glacial lake and flood risks, though no formal treaty was signed. The disaster underscores the need for stronger regional collaboration, with governments taking coordinated action to respond to cross-border disasters. China’s information control could hamper flood rescue efforts in Tibet. In a situation where “only the Chinese government controls the information flow, that means that local residents, afraid of punishment, are not posting about where people are trapped or where the damage is the worst,” alleges The New York Times.

The 46,000 glaciers, the vast permafrost on the Tibetan Plateau and its rivers are major sources of water for rivers across Asia. China’s control of the Tibetan Plateau, the source of 10 major Asian rivers, including the Mekong, Irrawaddy, Ganges (Maja-khabab), Indus (Senge-khabab), Brahmaputra (Tachog-khabab) and Sutlej (Langchen-khabab), gives it unprecedented hydro-strategic leverage.

For India and Bangladesh, the Yarlung Tsangpo dam represents a clear and present danger. The river, known as the Siang in Arunachal Pradesh and the Brah-



China’s upstream control threatens downstream Asian water security

SHARED RIVERS DEMAND COOPERATION, TRANSPARENCY AND TIMELY EXCHANGE OF DATA

maputra in Assam, supports 130 million Indians downstream before becoming the Jamuna in Bangladesh, where it sustains 160 million people. On the Mekong, China’s 12 cascade dams have demonstrably reduced downstream flows by up to 70 per cent during critical periods. Indian analysts fear similar manipulation could turn the Brahmaputra into a “water bomb”, with sudden releases causing catastrophic flooding in Assam and Arunachal Pradesh. Bangladesh faces compounded risks, as only seven per cent of the Brahmaputra-Meghna-Ganges watershed lies within its

territory, leaving it wholly dependent on upstream cooperation. The Brahmaputra carries 401 million tonnes of silt annually, replenishing Bangladesh’s delta and sustaining its rice production. Chinese dams could trap this nutrient-rich sediment, devastating agricultural productivity and accelerating delta subsidence.

China is turning water into a strategic weapon. Rivers from Tibet feed more than 46 per cent of the people in Southeast Asia. Its water dams are becoming potential water bombs. China is now pursuing major inter-basin and inter-river water transfer projects on the Tibetan Plateau, which threaten to diminish international river flows into India and other co-riparian states, observes strategic expert Brahma Chellaney.

It may be recalled that, on the Indus Waters Treaty, a prominent Chinese commentator recently sparked a debate by warning India about its river waters. Speaking at a seminar in Islamabad, Victor Gao, vice president of the Beijing-based Center

for China and Globalisation, suggested that if India tries to “weaponise” the Indus Waters Treaty against Pakistan, China has the power to do the same with rivers originating in Tibet. India held the Indus Waters Treaty in abeyance as part of a package of punitive diplomatic and economic measures unveiled in April 2025 in response to the Pahalgam terror attack. Since it suspended the treaty, the Indian side has stepped up work on several hydropower projects in Jammu and Kashmir that Pakistan opposed under the provisions of the 1960 pact. In a statement, the Permanent Court of Arbitration (PCA) said, “In a unanimous decision, the Court found that none of these grounds could justify suspension or termination of the Treaty. Accordingly, the Indus Waters Treaty remains fully in force, and India must observe its obligations under the Treaty, including those relating to the design and operation of its hydro-electric projects on the Western Rivers.” In response, the MEA said the Hague-based court has no jurisdiction to pronounce on India’s sovereign decisions and that the treaty will remain in abeyance.

As the 30-year Ganga water-sharing treaty between India and Bangladesh nears expiry by the end of this year, India should prepare its homework properly to maintain its cordial relations with Bangladesh. With the Teesta project in Bangladesh likely to be managed by China, India must develop a coordinated water treaty and ensure the timely exchange of critical data with China, without further delay, to avoid Nepal-like disasters.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Tit-for-tat: Russia to close German cultural centres

MOSCOW: Russia will shutter German cultural centres across the country, Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov said Thursday, in a tit-for-tat measure that reflected soured relations and deepening tensions between Moscow and European countries that are helping Ukraine resist Russia's invasion.

Lavrov's announcement came after Berlin blamed Moscow for an attempted attack at Leipzig/Halle Airport. Germany said it was closing both the Russian Consulate in Bonn and the Russian House cultural centre in the German capital.

Norway seizes Russian ship to enforce \$4.2 billion claim

OSLO: Norwegian authorities seized a Russian vessel in the Arctic archipelago of Svalbard on Wednesday at the request of Ukraine's Naftogaz as part of a global effort to enforce a \$4.22 billion arbitration award.

Naftogaz is trying to recover the multibillion-dollar arbitration award stemming from Russia's 2014 illegal annexation of Crimea and its seizure of Ukrainian energy assets. In 2023, an arbitration tribunal in The Hague ordered Russia to pay the \$4.22 billion to the Ukrainian energy company.

Dozens feared dead in boat adrift off Canary Islands

BARCELONA: At least five people died and dozens more were feared dead after a boat carrying West African migrants ran into trouble in the Atlantic Ocean. Forty-four people were brought to safety in the Canary Islands.

Spain's Maritime Rescue Service said Thursday that one of its planes had spotted a "precarious" boat drifting some 120 km (74 miles) south of the island of Gran Canaria on Wednesday afternoon.

Three survivors were immediately evacuated by helicopter to a hospital on the island.



France's President Emmanuel Macron and his wife Brigitte Macron at 10 Downing Street, in London on Thursday

AP/PTI

Briefs

Japanese scientist dies at 90

TOKYO: Japanese scientist Hideki Shirakawa, co-winner of the 2000 Nobel Prize in chemistry for discovering and developing conductive polymers, has died. He was 90.

The discovery by Shirakawa and two fellow American scientists, Alan Heeger and Alan MacDiarmid, demonstrated that plastic could conduct electricity like metal and be used in applications such as electronics.

Shirakawa died on August 24, according to the University of Tsukuba, where he taught and researched after joining in 1979. The university did not specify a cause of death. Japan's largest newspaper, the Yomiuri, said Shirakawa died at a hospital in Yokohama, west of Tokyo.

Activist Gloria Steinem dies

WASHINGTON: Former First Lady Jill Biden, writers and social justice activists are lauding Gloria Steinem as a revolutionary and inspiring figure.

The celebrated author and activist, who became one of the most visible symbols and potent voices of the US women's movement, died Wednesday at her home in New York City. She was 92.

"Gloria Steinem understood that women's equality begins with the freedom to make decisions about our own bodies, health, and futures."

China sacks 4 top professors

BEIJING: Four prominent Chinese academics have lost their posts, and more than 40 researchers at universities and hospitals are facing investigations as China has launched its largest-ever public crack-down on academic misconduct.

On August 26, the National Natural Science Foundation of China (NSFC) published details of 31 new misconduct cases at universities and hospitals across China, involving more than 40 researchers, the Hong Kong-based SCMP reported.

DEATH TOLL SURGES TO 1,259

Families perform symbolic funeral for thousands still missing in Nepal

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Kathmandu, September 3

The death toll due to devastating flash floods in Nepal surged to 1,259 on Thursday, with over 5,000 still missing as families perform symbolic funeral rites for their relatives after receiving no information about them for days.

The flash floods, triggered by an ice-rock avalanche near the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26, devastated towns and villages in northern and central Nepal, leaving a trail of destruction.

According to the data released by Nepal's National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA), the death toll from the Bhotekoshi River floods surged to 1,259 on Thursday, with 5,083 still missing.

In Paharebesi village of Rasuwa district, residents have begun preparing to perform funeral rites for missing relatives after receiving no information about their whereabouts for eight days. Onlinekhabar news portal reported on Thursday.

In flood-hit areas, families have begun using effigies made of kusha grass to perform the final rites



People offer prayers for victims of the flash floods at Boudhanath Stupa, in Kathmandu on Thursday

PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

» The flash floods, triggered by an ice-rock avalanche near the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26

» 127 bodies were recovered from Rasuwa district, 72 from Gorkha, 60 from Dhading and 38 from Tahanu

of relatives who remain untraced, amid diminish-

ing hopes of finding them alive, The Kathmandu Post

newspaper reported.

Families said they were turning to symbolic funerals because there was little hope of recovering all the missing and because identifying bodies had become increasingly difficult, it said.

According to NDRRMA, 355 bodies have been recovered from Chitawan

district, 218 from Nawalparasi East, 212 from Nawalparasi West, including 18 recovered from India and handed over to Nawalparasi West, and 177 from Nuwakot.

Similarly, 127 bodies were recovered from Rasuwa district, 72 from Gorkha, 60 from Dhading and 38 from Tahanu.

Uganda names its crude oil blend 'Pearl Sweet' Ahead of commercial production

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Dubai, September 3

Ugandan authorities on Wednesday named the country's prospective crude oil blend "Pearl Sweet," marking a milestone as the East African country gears up for commercial production by the end of the year.

Officials announced the name at a remote oil infrastructure site, celebrating Uganda's emergence as an oil pro-

ducer. The name chosen for Uganda's crude oil blend is a nod to Winston Churchill's description of Uganda in the last century as "the pearl of Africa," and officials said the "sweet" in the nomenclature reflects the crude blend's low sulphur content.

"The name combines national identity with a commercial description," the Ministry of Energy said in a statement.

Ukraine's attacks caused turmoil for Russians throughout summer

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Moscow, September 3

There were long lines at gas pumps, turning each fill-up into an ordeal. Flights to vacation destinations were canceled, delayed or rerouted. Online orders were disrupted as e-commerce hubs were set ablaze by buzzing drones.

It's been a difficult summer for Russians – a season of almost daily turmoil, frustration and anxiety. The war that President

“THE WAR UNLEASHED ON UKRAINE 4½ YEARS AGO HAS COME HOME AND IS HARDER TO IGNORE

Vladimir Putin unleashed on Ukraine 4½ years ago has come home and is harder to ignore. Nightly swarms of drones closed Russian airports, struck oil refineries or set ablaze the warehouses of retail giants

Wildberries and Ozon.

Over 43,300 Ukrainian drones were intercepted over Russia and illegally annexed Crimea in June, July and August, according to Defense Ministry data compiled by The Associated Press, although some clearly hit their targets. In the same period last summer, about 7,700 were intercepted, the ministry said.

"We were living a normal life, and then suddenly it's like this," retiree Margarita Terekhova said.

Syria begins destroying Assad-era chemical weapons

AGENCIES

Beirut, September 3

Syria has begun destroying the remnants of a clandestine Assad-era chemical weapons program that it recovered in May, the first such destruction in a decade, a Syrian envoy and a U.N. representative said on Thursday.

Reuters reported in May that Syria's new leadership had located remnants of former Syr-

ian President Bashar al-Assad's chemical weapons program.

Izumi Nakamitsu, the United Nations High Representative for Disarmament Affairs, told a Security Council briefing on Thursday that for the first time since 2014, the Organisation for the Prohibition of Chemical Weapons had verified the destruction of chemical munitions in Syria.



SIRENS SOUNDED IN KUWAIT EARLY THURSDAY, WHERE AIR DEFENCES INTERCEPTED MISSILES AND DRONES DURING A 'BLATANT IRANIAN AGGRESSION'

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Dubai, September 3

Iran fired at Kuwait on Thursday as part of its retaliation for US bombardments earlier in the week. Meanwhile, Israeli police said they arrested a settler allegedly involved in an attack on Palestinians last week.

Sirens sounded in Kuwait early Thursday, where air defences intercepted missiles and drones during a "blatant Iranian aggression," the Defence Ministry said on X. It came after US allies Bahrain and Jordan said their air defence systems also intercepted several Iranian air attacks Wednesday.

Fighting between the US and Iran has increased this week after the US hit Iranian rocket launchers on an island in the Strait of Hormuz on Sunday, saying Iran was planning to use them to shoot mines into the waterway.

Ship traffic through the Strait of Hormuz remains well below pre-war levels due to the risk of Iranian attack if ships do not comply with an Iranian vetting regime.

The decline is in sharp contrast to the unhindered navigation before the war. Last week there were 102 transits and 126 the week before, according to ship-

ping data company Lloyd's List Intelligence. That compares with 130 or more per day before the war.

Significant amounts of oil, however, continue to flow through the strait due to a shuttle trade in which tanker operators risk going through a southern route near the coast of Oman under the guidance of US forces.

It's difficult for observers to estimate how much oil is reaching global markets through this dark shuttle channel because the ships turn off tracking systems that show where they are.

Judge blocks Trump's new bid to curb birthright citizenship

Trump has long wanted to end policy

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Maryland, September 3



US President Donald Trump

A federal judge has blocked President Donald Trump's latest attempt to limit birthright citizenship, granting a preliminary injunction against an executive order that the administration said would target "birth tourism."

US District Judge Deborah L. Boardman in Maryland on Wednesday issued the injunction until a class-action lawsuit brought by immigrant families and advocacy groups is resolved.

"The Supreme Court has

spoken: Children in the certified class are citizens at birth," Boardman, appointed by President Joe Biden, wrote in Wednesday's ruling.

Birthright citizenship is guaranteed under current law for anyone who is

born on US soil, with a few exceptions.

The law stretches back to 1868, when the 14th Amendment was ratified in the aftermath of the Civil War.

But Trump has long wanted to end birthright cit-

izenship, issuing a previous executive order declaring that children born to people who are in the United States illegally or temporarily are not American citizens. The Supreme Court struck down that attempt in June.

In August, the president tried again with a narrower executive order that appeared to restrict automatic citizenship for specific categories of people, including children born to adults with connections to foreign embassies or organisations or to anyone considered an "alien enemy" of the United States.

KEY POINTS

» The law stretches back to 1868, when the 14th Amendment was ratified in the aftermath of the Civil War

» Birthright citizenship is guaranteed under current law for anyone who is born on US soil, with a few exceptions

» The court grants a preliminary injunction against an executive order that would 'target birth tourism'

News at a glance

Tata Power commissions 400 kV Jalpura-Khurja corridor

NEW DELHI: Tata Power on Thursday said it has commissioned the 400 kV Jalpura-Khurja transmission corridor in Uttar Pradesh. The project comprises a double-circuit transmission line from Khurja to Jalpura, spanning 162 circuit kilometres (ckm) and a gas-insulated switchgear substation at Jalpura with 1,000 MVA transformation capacity, the company said in an exchange filing.

Khurja is an important power node in Western Uttar Pradesh, playing a strategic role in enabling efficient transmission of power towards NCR and Noida, the company said.

HZL secures mining lease for rare earth block in Karnataka

NEW DELHI: Vedanta group firm Hindustan Zinc Ltd (HZL) on Thursday said it has secured a mining lease for the Gundlupet rare earth element (REE) and Yttrium block in Karnataka, spanning 314.21 hectares.

The Karnataka government issued a Letter of Intent (LoI) to HZL, the preferred bidder, for the block in Malayanapur village, Gundlupet Taluka, Chamrajnagar District, under Rule 10(2) of the Mineral Auction Rules 2015. HZL Chairperson Priya Agarwal Hebbar said the company is pursuing exploration opportunities in rare earth elements and other critical minerals, including copper, lithium, nickel, cobalt and potash.

Navi Mumbai Int’l Airport hits 3 million passenger mark

MUMBAI: Navi Mumbai International Airport (NMIA), promoted by Adani Group and CIDCO, on Thursday said it has handled 3 million passengers since starting commercial operations last December, establishing the greenfield facility as one of India’s most promising new aviation gateways.

The milestone was achieved due to NMIA’s strong operational performance & commitment to passenger service standards, the airport operator said. NMIA started domestic commercial operations on December 25, 2025, while the commercial international passenger services commenced on July 15 this year.

Kenya’s President orders Tata Chemicals exit the country

NAIROBI: Kenyan President William Ruto on Thursday ordered Tata Chemicals to stop operations in the country, saying its presence had failed to benefit Kenya. Ruto said the government would bring in two new firms to take over Tata Chemicals’ operations. In late July, Tata said Kenya’s government had ordered Tata Chemical, to suspend operations at Magadi Soda factory & halt soda ash exports.

Ruto said Tata had held the contract for 100 years but had not built a factory in Kajiado. He said one new company would establish a large glass plant and another would manufacture chemicals in the region.

TRANSACTION COMPLIED WITH THE LAW IN FORCE AT THE TIME
Maha Charity Commissioner closes probe in Tata Sons 1989 share transfer

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, September 3

The Maharashtra Charity Commissioner has closed a complaint seeking an inquiry into the 1989 transfer of 833 shares of Tata Sons from the Navajbai Ratan Tata Trust (NRTT) to the late Naval H. Tata, finding that the transaction complied with the law in force at the time, Tata Trusts said in a statement Thursday.

The order, dated September 2, follows a complaint filed on June 10 by Vijay Singh, a trustee of the NRTT, seeking an independent inquiry into the nearly 40-year-old transfer of shares to Naval H. Tata, the father of current Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata.

“The Tata Trusts are in receipt of the Charity Commissioner’s Order, Maharashtra State, Mumbai, dated 2nd September 2026 disposing off a complaint received from Vijay Singh, Trustee, NRTT, vide email dated 10th June, 2026 which sought an inquiry into the transfer of 833 shares of Tata Sons Private Limited from NRTT to Mr Naval H. Tata in 1989,” it said.

“The Tata Trusts stand vindicated in their assertion that the allegations relating to the transfer of shares were baseless, unsubstan-



THE ORDER, DATED SEPTEMBER 2, FOLLOWS A COMPLAINT FILED ON JUNE 10 BY VIJAY SINGH, A TRUSTEE OF THE NAVAJBAI RATAN TATA TRUST

tiated and malafide. These were undertaken as part of a wilful, malicious and orchestrated campaign which had, as its sole aim, the objective of discrediting the Tata Trusts - an institution which has, for more than 130 years, served the country and consistently held itself to the highest standards of public trust, accountability and ethical conduct,” the statement said.

The commissioner, after examining the complaint, the trust’s response and supporting documents, concluded that no further inquiry under the Maha-

ashtra Public Trusts Act, 1950, was warranted, according to Tata Trusts.

According to the statement, the commissioner found that the sale was necessitated by statutory requirements and that the share transfer was supported by proper documentation. The consideration paid to the trust was based on a valuation agreed by the Commissioner of Wealth Tax, and the trust made a profit on the transaction that was reflected in its balance sheet as of March 31, 1989, Tata Trusts said.

The order also found that the shares were trans-

KEY POINTS

- » ‘The Tata Trusts stand vindicated in their assertion that the allegations relating to the transfer of shares were baseless, unsubstantiated and malafide’
- » ‘These were undertaken as part of a wilful, malicious and orchestrated campaign which had the objective of discrediting the Tata Trusts, which has served the country for over 130 years’
- » The commissioner concluded that no further inquiry under the Maharashtra Public Trusts Act, 1950, was warranted, according to Tata Trusts

ferred subject to a condition that they would not be sold to a third party and would remain within the recipient’s family. The commissioner concluded that the transfer was made in compliance with the applicable law at the time, the statement said. The dispute had resurfaced this year after allegations were made that the shares, which were held by a public charitable trust, had been transferred to Naval Tata in his personal capacity without adequate consideration, trustee approval or the required documentation. Those allegations were denied by Tata Trusts.

Ashok Leyland MD Shenu Agarwal takes over as SIAM President

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 3

The Executive Committee of the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM), the apex body representing the country’s leading automobile manufacturers, on Thursday elected Ashok Leyland Ltd Managing Director & CEO Shenu Agarwal as its President for 2026-27.

Agarwal, who previously served as the Vice President of SIAM, succeeds Shailesh Chandra, Immediate Past President, SIAM, and Managing Director & CEO, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Limited.

The new office bearers were elected during the SIAM’s Executive Committee Meeting held on Thursday.

The members of SIAM also elected K N Radhakrishnan, Director & CEO, TVS Motor Company, as the Vice President of SIAM for 2026-27.

Santosh Iyer, Managing Director & CEO, Mercedes-Benz India Pvt Ltd, has been elected as the Treasurer of Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers for 2026-27, the automobile industry body said.

Aditya Birla Group plugs into wires & cables business with ₹1,800 cr bet

AGENCIES
New Delhi, September 3

The Aditya Birla Group on Thursday entered the wires and cables business with a Rs 1,800 crore investment, launching the new venture under the brand ‘Ultravolt’.

Chairman Kumar Mangalam Birla said the venture is the group’s third major business launch in three years, following paints, B2B e-commerce and jewellery retail. The group aims to become the second-largest player in the category within 3-5 years.

Birla said expertise in aluminium and copper, which account for about 80 per cent of wires and cables costs, will support the business. The group has built a manufacturing plant in Gujarat’s Bharuch and will start operations across 500 districts and 6,000 pincodes.

Ultravolt will have a network of over 700 distributors at launch. Birla said urbanisation, electrification and digitisation will drive demand, alongside power-grid modernisation, renewable energy, metro

rail expansion, electric vehicles and data centres.

The group said its cement business provides insights into construction needs, potentially helping Ultravolt identify opportunities 4-6 months ahead of competitors.

Birla highlighted the group’s recent ventures, including Birla Opus, Indriya and Birla Pivot, as examples of successful new-business launches.

He said responsible manufacturing and safe installation would be key principles for Ultravolt.

Services sector activity expands in August, pace of growth cools to over 4-year low: PMI

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 3

India’s services activity expanded in August, supported by stronger output and new business, even as the overall pace of growth was the second-lowest recorded since March 2022, a monthly survey said on Thursday.

The seasonally adjusted HSBC India Services PMI Business Activity Index rose from 53.3 in July to 54.1 in August, as demand conditions remained supportive

and new business inflows continued to rise.

The rate of expansion recorded in August was the second-weakest since March 2022, amid subdued bookings, strong competition and reduced transport operations.

The HSBC India Services PMI Business Activity Index is based on a single question asking how the level of business activity compares with the situation the month before.

“India’s services activity expanded faster in August.

Growth was supported by stronger output and new business, although the overall pace was still among the weakest seen in over four years, with some firms citing subdued bookings, competition and reduced transport operations,” said Pranjul Bhandari, Chief India Economist at HSBC.

Firms nevertheless continued to hire, with job creation reaching a 15-month high, while price pressures picked up only modestly.

“Employment increased at a marked rate, with

job creation reaching a 15-month high. Price pressures picked up only modestly: input cost inflation edged up slightly, while prices charged rose at the fastest rate since March as firms passed on higher operating costs,” Bhandari said.

Companies reported higher spending on digital platforms, electricity, inputs, labour, marketing and regulatory requirements. Meanwhile, international demand continued to support growth.

Adani expands in non-BJP states with ₹5L cr pipeline
In Telangana Adani Group firms signed MoUs worth Rs 12,400 crore

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, September 3

The Adani Group is expanding its presence across Congress-led and other non-BJP-ruled states, with projects worth about Rs 5 lakh crore spanning roads, ports, power, renewables, cement and data centres, sources said.

The group is pursuing investments in Karnataka, Telangana, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Bihar, Andhra Pradesh, Jharkhand and Himachal Pradesh, reflecting growing demand for



private capital for infrastructure and job creation.

In Karnataka, Adani Enterprises emerged as the lowest bidder for both packages of the proposed 16.75-km north-south tunnel road in Bengaluru, quoting Rs 22,267 crore.

CLOSER LOOK

- » In Andhra Pradesh, Adani is investing over Rs 20,000 crore in renewable capacity and transmission lines
- » In Kerala, Adani Ports developed Vizhinjam International Seaport & launched its 2nd phase in January 2026 with an additional Rs 16K cr, taking cumulative investment to about Rs 30,000 cr

The contract is yet to be finalised. The group already operates the 1,200-MW Udipi power plant and Mangaluru International Airport.

In Kerala, Adani Ports developed Vizhinjam International Seaport and launched its second phase in January 2026 with an additional Rs 16,000 crore, taking cumulative investment to about Rs 30,000 crore. It also operates Thiruvananthapuram airport.

Telangana signed MoUs

with Adani companies worth Rs 12,400 crore, while Tamil Nadu attracted MoUs exceeding Rs 42,700 crore.

In Bihar, Adani plans to invest Rs 50,000 crore to Rs 60,000 crore over three to four years, including a Rs 27,000 crore, 2,400-MW power project. The group also operates Jharkhand’s 1,600-MW Godda plant.

In Andhra Pradesh, Adani is investing over Rs 20,000 crore in renewable capacity and transmission lines and operates Krishnapatnam Port.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE

IndianOil on Thursday launched the SERVO HYPER SERIES, its most advanced premium lubricant portfolio, in Kolkata, in presence of Saumitra P Srivastava, Director (Marketing), and Arvind Kumar, Director (Refineries), IndianOil.

RECENT FTAs PROVIDED GREATER ACCESS TO GLOBAL MARKETS

PM exhorts auto industry to chart bold pathway towards Viksit Bharat

OUR CORRESPONDENT

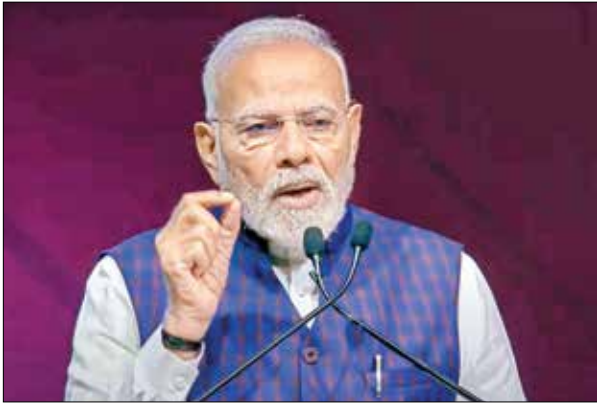
New Delhi, September 3

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday exhorted India's automobile industry to continue innovating, pursue excellence, and proactively chart a bold pathway towards the Viksit Bharat vision by 2047.

In a message to the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) read out at its Annual Convention 2026 on Thursday, the Prime Minister said, with recent free trade agreements providing greater access to international markets, the Indian automobile sector, already recognised across many parts of the world, is well placed to further expand its global presence.

"I urge the Indian automobile industry to continue innovating, pursuing excellence, and proactively charting a bold pathway towards Viksit Bharat," the PM said in his message read out by SIAM President Shailesh Chandra.

This journey will bring



Prime Minister Narendra Modi

THIS JOURNEY WILL BRING TRANSFORMATIVE OPPORTUNITIES AND SIGNIFICANT GROWTH FOR THE MOBILITY SECTOR, WHILE FURTHER STRENGTHENING TRANSPORT AS A KEY PILLAR OF NATIONAL DEVELOPMENT, THE PM SAID

transformative opportunities and significant growth for the mobility sector, while further strengthening transport as a key pillar of national development, the Prime Minister added.

"India has been one of the fastest-growing major economies in the world

over the last decade. As our economy grows, the demand for mobility is also rising," the Prime Minister observed.

The rapid expansion of highways and other infrastructure is facilitating the movement of people and goods, while creating new opportunities for the

KEY POINTS

» 'India has been one of the fastest-growing major economies in the world over the last decade. As our economy grows, the demand for mobility is also rising,' he observed

» 'Better connectivity & more efficient logistics are reducing costs & making Indian manufacturing more competitive. This is strengthening the automobile sector and contributing to India's economic growth'

» 'The rapid expansion of charging infrastructure is encouraging greater adoption of electric vehicles and creating new opportunities for innovation,' the prime minister said

automobile industry, Modi highlighted.

"Better connectivity and more efficient logistics are reducing costs and making Indian manufacturing more competitive. This is strengthening the automobile sector and contributing to India's economic growth," he said.

He pointed out that India is also taking significant strides towards a cleaner and more sustainable mobility ecosystem.

"The rapid expansion of charging infrastructure is encouraging greater adoption of electric vehicles and creating new opportunities for innovation," the prime minister said.

As India moves towards the next generation of mobility, SIAM can play an important role in shaping this transformation and taking India's automotive capabilities to greater heights, the prime minister's message said.

"In recent years, the government's reforms to boost ease of doing business, including the removal of redundant laws and removal of unnecessary compliances have provided fresh impetus to the industry. Initiatives such as the PLI (production-linked incentive) scheme and Make in India have further strengthened the manufacturing capabilities of the automobile industry," said the prime minister.

FM: India's 7.8% growth despite global disruptions remarkable

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New York, September 3

India recorded a "remarkable growth" of 7.8 per cent in the first quarter of fiscal year 2026-27 despite global disruptions, and against all odds, remains the fastest-growing major economy in the world, Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said.

Sitharaman on Wednesday participated in a high-level business roundtable with investors, organised by the Consulate General of India in New York in association with Bank of America, New York.

Addressing investors, Sitharaman said that "despite global disruptions and against all odds, India continues to be the fastest-growing major economy in the world, recording a remarkable growth of 7.8 per cent in Q1 of FY 2026-27," the Finance Ministry said in a post on X.

Sitharaman arrived here after participating in the G20 finance ministerial meeting in Asheville, North Carolina. Sitharaman added that with its strong reform orientation, India has also provided greater regulatory certainty through a range of reforms, including



Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman

INDIA HAS CONSISTENTLY REMAINED COMMITTED TO PATH OF FISCAL PRUDENCE & FISCAL DISCIPLINE OVER THE PAST SEVERAL YEARS, SHE SAID

the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code.

"Such reforms have contributed to ensuring ease of compliance and reducing paperwork, which has remained a prime focus of the Government of India since it assumed office over a decade ago," the post on X said.

She added that among the key areas on which the government has focused are creation of capital assets and providing sustained support to industry through infrastructure

development, particularly aviation; fostering a friendly and conducive investment climate; promoting the development of AI and data centres; supporting global capability centres; ensuring credit availability to MSMEs; and reducing non-performing assets (NPAs) of banks.

These measures have helped create a more enabling business environment for banks and industry to thrive, grow and emerge stronger, the finance minister said. Sitharaman further said that India has consistently remained committed to the path of fiscal prudence and fiscal discipline over the past several years, despite the ongoing challenges confronting the global economy since the onset of COVID-19.

She highlighted the investment climate in India that has improved significantly, with both the central government and state governments demonstrating greater keenness and competitiveness in attracting and facilitating investments in their respective regions. Such efforts are part of the larger national endeavour towards achieving the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047, she said.

Briefs

Rupee rises 22 paise to 94.51/dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee appreciated by 22 paise to close at 94.51 against the US dollar, buoyed by the country's improved balance of payment condition following higher-than-expected forex deposits.

At the interbank forex market, the rupee opened at 94.30 & traded in range of 94.26-94.66, before settling for the day at 94.51, up by 22 paise.

Mahindra to expand in Gujarat

NEW DELHI: Mahindra Group Chairman Anand Mahindra said the group is exploring expansion & new opportunities in Gujarat after meeting Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel during the Mumbai roadshow for Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit 2027.

Mahindra Group CEO Anish Shah said discussions covered larger industrial parks, GIFT City, additional manufacturing, hospitality, electric vehicles and future mobility.

Markets decline for 4th straight day amid rising crude, IT sell-off

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Mumbai, September 3

Equity benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty buckled under lag-end selling pressure for the fourth straight session on Thursday as rising crude oil prices and losses in IT stocks weighed on investor sentiment.

The 30-share BSE Sensex dropped 417.49 points, or 0.55 per cent, to close at 76,152.86.

A total of 2,545 stocks advanced, while 1,778 declined and 223 remained unchanged on the BSE.

The 50-share NSE Nifty slipped 41 points, or 0.17 per cent, to settle at 23,873.45.

Among the 30 Sensex firms, Titan, Trent, ITC, Mahindra & Mahindra, Bajaj Finserv, HCL Technologies, Tech Mahindra, Sun Pharmaceuticals, Tata Consultancy Services, UltraTech Cement and Bajaj Finance were the major laggards. In contrast, Axis Bank, Adani Ports, Asian Paints, HDFC Bank, Bharti Airtel, Bharat Electronics Ltd and Tata Steel were among the gainers.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, rose 1.57 per cent to \$97.13 per barrel.

In broader market, SmallCap Select Index rising 1.02 per cent and Mid-Cap Select Index gaining

0.09 per cent.

Among the BSE sectoral indices, Focused IT was the biggest loser, declining 1.01 per cent, followed by IT (1 per cent), Consumer Durables declined (0.61 per cent), Auto (0.47 per cent), FMCG (0.45 per cent), Telecom (0.44 per cent), Consumer Discretionary (0.26 per cent) and Healthcare (0.19 per cent).

On the other hand, the Realty index emerged as the biggest gainer, rising 2.39 per cent. Capital Goods, Housing Finance, Industrials, Power, PSU Bank, Services, MidSmall Private Banks and Private Banks indices also closed higher.

Food sits at the centre of India's shift towards preventive health: FSSAI CEO Rajit Punhani

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 3

India's growing focus on preventive healthcare is placing nutrition and food safety at the centre of efforts to reduce the long-term disease burden, said Rajit Punhani, Chief Executive Officer, Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI), at the 'Illness to Wellness' Conference on Healthy Nutrition for a Healthy Nation.

Punhani said, "There is a clear shift in the public-health landscape towards prevention, and food sits right at the centre of this transition." He highlighted FSSAI initiatives including



Eat Right School, Eat Right Campus and Eat Right Thali to promote informed food choices.

Organised by the Illness to Wellness Foundation, the conference brought together policy-makers and health experts.

Indian Army, City Gas Distribution industry join hands to accelerate transition to PNG

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 3

The Indian Army PNG Transition Webinar 2026 was organised at Manekshaw Centre, New Delhi, on Thursday under the theme "Sena Sampark - Nirantar Urja, Nirantar Suraksha" to accelerate adoption of cleaner and reliable energy solutions across Army establishments.

Organised by Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL) in association with the Indian Army and



Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board (PNGRB), the programme brought together the City Gas Distribution (CGD) industry to

create a coordinated roadmap for PNG adoption.

In the first phase, 41 Army establishments have been identified for PNG

conversion. Letters of Understanding were signed between 8 Army Stations and 6 CGD entities, covering more than 20,000 households. The entities include BPCL, IGL, Think Gas, Torrent Gas, HPCL and CUGL.

Rahul Tandon, Business Head - Gas, BPCL, said the transition would help build a reliable, continuous and future-ready energy ecosystem. PNG infrastructure and connections are targeted for completion by end-FY27.

AGENCIES

New Delhi, September 3

The average all-India retail price of sugar declined 3.85 per cent to Rs 62.57 per kg in a week following recent government measures, including allowing imports and tightening stockholding norms for bulk users and dealers, according to official data.

The retail price fell from Rs 65.08 per kg a week ago but remained 27 per cent higher than the previous month's Rs 49.33 per kg.

The average wholesale price also declined to Rs 57.62 per kg on September 2 from Rs 60.39 per kg a week earlier, data maintained by the consumer affairs ministry showed.

Sources said the fall in wholesale prices takes time to reflect in retail markets as retailers holding stocks bought at higher rates avoid selling at a loss. A retailer typically holds 10-15 bags of sugar, each weighing 50 kg, and retail prices adjust only after fresh stock is procured at lower rates.

"It takes at least ten days to reflect changes in the retail price," an industry source said.

To curb the price rise, the government allowed import of 10 lakh tonnes of sugar and tightened stockholding norms. The Centre blamed mills for "jacking up" prices while maintaining that stocks are adequate. Production for 2025-26 has been revised to 306 lakh tonnes from 343 lakh tonnes, against annual domestic demand of 280-285 lakh tonnes.

RBI Dy Guv asks NBFCs to prioritise asset quality

AGENCIES

Mumbai, September 3

RBI Deputy Governor S C Murmu on Thursday urged NBFCs to ensure faster loan growth does not compromise asset quality, while focusing on liquidity management, fair conduct, grievance redressal and responsible lending.

"As credit growth speeds up, so does the risk to asset quality... Let me be clear, growth must never come at the cost of underwriting standards," Murmu said at a CII event.

He called for "rigorous" stress testing, early

warning systems, dynamic provisioning and use of artificial intelligence and machine learning to detect borrower stress.

NBFC credit is above 16.7 per cent of nominal GDP, up from 15.9 per cent a year earlier, and accounts for about 27 per cent of scheduled commercial bank credit, up from 26 per cent.

Hero Fincorp CEO and Managing Director Abhimanyu Munjal sought deeper bond and pass-through certificate markets and revised ECB norms to expand global capital access through GIFT City.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



The National Jute Board (NJB) participated in the 102nd Tokyo International Gift Show Autumn 2026, held from September 2-4 at the Tokyo International Exhibition Centre, Japan. The India Pavilion was inaugurated on Wednesday by R Madhusudhan, Deputy Chief of Mission, Embassy of India, Tokyo. Six Indian exporters participated under the India Jute Pavilion, comprising seven stalls.



National Jute Board (NJB) participated in ASD Market Week 2026 in Las Vegas from August 25-27. The India Jute Pavilion was jointly inaugurated by Kulwant Singh, Consul, Consulate General of India, Los Angeles, and Shashi Bhushan Singh, Secretary, NJB. Seven Indian exporters participated across eight stalls.



Punjab & Sind Bank organised an NRI Customer Meet in Brampton, Canada, in association with the PSB Seniors Club Association, Canada. MD & CEO, Swarup Kumar Saha & General Manager, Chaman Lal Shienhmar, interacted with participants. Harcharan Singh, President, PSB Seniors Club Association, Canada, alongwith Gian Paul, Vice President & Sukhdev Bedi, Director welcomed the visiting executives.



UJVN LIMITED
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H.O. "ULJANAL" MAHARAJ BAGH, GMS ROAD, DEHRADUN - 248006, CN No. 04016/1UR201/SCC232866
Tel.: 0135-2763508, 2763509, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvn.com

Tender No.769

Date : 03.09.2026

e-Tender corrigendum Notice-06
In continuation to uploaded below e-tender for Construction of Tankul SHP (3 x 4 MW) on river simkholagad at tehsil Dharchula in dist. Pithoragarh of Uttarakhand, Technical corrigendum has been uploaded in the portal.
Tender No.: 03/EE (Civil-SHP)/ Dharchula/ 2026-27
Name of work: Construction of trench weir, power intake including river diversion arrangements, desilting tank, feeder pipe, tunnel, surge shaft, power house, hydro mechanical works of Tankul SHP (3 x 4 MW) on river simkholagad at tehsil Dharchula in dist. Pithoragarh of Uttarakhand.
Bid submission closing date on portal: 11.09.2026 upto 17: 00 Hrs
For full & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "http://uktenders.gov.in".
Executive Engineer (Civil-SHP)
"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"



JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Mohd Irfan S/O Mohd Ishaq Khan R/O Village Naloosa, Tehsil Boniyar, District Baramulla, A/P Near LG Showroom Malik Market, Jammu is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 143/2026 U/S 21 of Immigration and Foreigners act, 2025 and 318(2)/336(3) BNS of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Mohd Irfan
S/O : Mohd Ishaq Khan
Address : Village Naloosa, Tehsil Boniyar, District Baramulla Near LG Showroom Malik Market, Jammu
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1.DPO, Jammu :0191-2547807,0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu :0191-2605949
4.SP City South : 0191-2430002
5. SDPO City East :01912433778
6.P/S Bahu Fort :0191-2475133
Sd/- Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu
DIP No:DIP/J-9414/26



JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Sanjeev Grover alias Palla S/O Pooran Chand R/O Fattu Chougan, Jammu is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 140/2006 U/S 302/109/212/382 RPC of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Sanjeev Grover alias Palla
S/O : Pooran Chand
Address : Fattu Chougan, Jammu
Age : 45-50 years
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1.DPO, Jammu :0191-2547807,0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu :0191-2605949
4.SP City South : 0191-2430002
5.SDPO City East : 01912433778
6.P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133
Sd/- Superintendent of Police Jammu
DIP No:DIP/J-9412/26

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Ms. Harjot Kaur
Civil Judge (Junior Division),
Bhiwani
NISITA RANI
Vs.
Addl. District Registrar Birth and Death
CNR No. HRBH02-000419-2026
Next Date 04-11-2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
GENERAL PUBLIC THROUGH THE STATE OF HARYANA
- BHIWANI
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **04-11-2026 at 10:00 am.**
For details login to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/2mod> = district notice & district = Bhiwani
Sd/- Ms. Harjot Kaur
Civil Judge (Junior Division),
Dated 03.09-2026 Bhiwani

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
(SUCCESSION CASE)
IN THE COURT OF Sh. Rakesh Kadian
Civil Judge (Senior Division) Rohtak
Manish Gupta Son of Lt. Sh. Babu Ram
Vs.
General Public
CNR No. HRBH02-001438-2026
Next Date 15.10.2026

NOTICE TO:
GENERAL PUBLIC
ROHTAK
In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **15.10.2026 at 10:00 a.m.**
For details login to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/2tr> = district Notice&district=Rohtak
Sd/- Sh. Rakesh Kadian
Civil Judge (Senior Division)
Dated 02.09.2026 Rohtak



JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Swaran Dass S/O Bhaditta R/O Chack Shabba Hiran Nagar Kathua is evading his arrest / wanted in case FIR No. 134/2006 U/S 420/468/471/109 RPC of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids / efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Swaran Dass
S/O : Bhaditta
Address : Chack Shabba Hiran Nagar Kathua
Age : 40-45 years
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1.DPO, Jammu :0191-2547807,0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu :0191-2605949
4.SP City South : 0191-2430002
5.SDPO City East :01912433778
6.P/S Bahu Fort :0191-2475133
Sd/- Superintendent of Police Jammu
DIP No:DIP/J-9380/26

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1 Name of Work with its location : Replacement of G-Jumper & PG Clamps in GZB-SRE & SPR section.	
2 Approx. Cost of work : Rs. 49,96,730.00/-	
3 Earnest Money Deposit : Rs. 99,900/-	
4 E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period : 14.09.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 28.09.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)	
5 E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time : 28.09.2026 (15.00 hrs.)	
6 Fund Allocation : 07041032	
7 Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen : www.irops.gov.in	

No.: 24A-TRD-NDLS-2026-27

Dated: 01.09.2026

3036/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF Ms. Meeta Kohli
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division),
Bhiwani
KELAPATI W/O OM PARKASH
Vs.
SMT. SHYAMA W/O SHREE KANT
SUIT FOR SYMBOLICAL POSSESSION
CASE No. CS-458-2026
CNR No. HRBH02-000784-2026
Next Date:- 12-10-2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:-
1. SMT. SHYAMA W/O SHREE KANT
2. RENU D/O SHREE KANT
3. YOGITA D/O SHREE KANT
ALL RESIDENTS OF PAROTHA, TEHSIL KANDAGHAT, DISTT. SOLAN HIMACHAL PARDESH
6. KALPANA D/O ARUN KANT
R/O PAROTHA, TEHSIL KANDAGHAT, DISTT. SOLAN HIMACHAL PARDESH
7. ARCHANA D/O ARUN KANT
R/O H.NO. 729, SECTOR-14, FARIDABAD
8. VIVEK S/O ARUN KANT
R/O PAROTHA, TEHSIL KANDAGHAT, DISTT. SOLAN HIMACHAL PARDESH
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **12-10-2026 at 10:00 am.**
For details login to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/2mod> = district notice & district = Bhiwani
Sd/- Ms. Meeta Kohli
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division),
dated 02-09-2026 Bhiwani

Court notice
In the court of Sh. Vivek yadav Addl.District & sessions judge Presiding officer Industrial Tribunal -cum-labour court Hisar
Pawan
Vs.
Irrigation Department panchkula
Case no R/04/2022
Next date 24-09-2026
PUBLICATION NOTICE TO:-
No 6. M/s. Tusar construction company (GOVT. Contractor)/ward no -17, near jharu chowk Charkhi Dadri district Charkhi dadri Through its proprietor/partner/contractor No 8.M/s.Platoon security contractor gurugram through its proprietor/partner/jai hind security No 9. A.R.R. security and man power agency LTD, Gurugram through its proprietor/partner
Whereas it has been proved to the satisfaction of the court that the respondent (s) named above cannot be served in the ordinary manner of service.Hence this proclamation under order 5 rule 20 CPC is hereby issued against him/ them and should appear in person or through counsel on 24-09-2026 at 10:00 a.m
Take notice that, in default of his/their appearance on the date mentioned above, the above said case will be heard and determined ex-parte in his/ her absence according to law
Given under my hand and the seal of the court this **05-03-2026**
Sd/- Sh.vivek yadav Addl.District& sessions judge Presiding officer industrial Tribunal -cum-labour court Hisar

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Sagar Mishra, S/o. Ram Kumar Mishra, R/o: Vegabond Zakhira Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 80044746/2025, U/s: 305/331(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sannhita**, registered at **P.S.: Sarai Rohilla Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Sagar Mishra** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Sagar Mishra** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Sagar Mishra, FIR No.: 80044746/2025, U/s: 305/331(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sannhita**, registered at **P.S.: Sarai Rohilla Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.10.2026**.
By Order
Sh.Ankil Solanki
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04 (Central)
Central District, Court Room No. 37
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi
DP/12272/N/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Auction Notice
Letter No.-DRM/C/AGRA/PARKING/E-AUCTION/2026 Dated:-01.09.2026
On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway-Agra invites E-Auction as per categories given as under:-

Category : Parking	Auction Catalogue No.: PARKNG-AGRA-MTJ
--------------------	--

Asset Details : Mathura Jn. Railway Station -Towards 1st Entry, Circulating Area-Mixed (Two Wheelers Three Wheelers and Four Wheelers) Parking.
E-Auction Start Date and time : Date:-17.09.2026, Time : 15:00
E-Auction End Date and time : Date:-17.09.2026, Time : 15:30
Note : Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.irops.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 2023/26 (D)
f North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in x @ CPONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPc
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Pratima W/o Ashish R/o Ground Floor, Premises Near Plot No.-74, Surya Kunj, Dichaon Kalan, New Delhi-72**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CT Cases No. 1505/2024, U/S 135 Indian Electricity Act, PS Baba Haridas Nagar, Dwarka Distt., New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Pratima** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pratima** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant);
Proclamation is hereby made that **Pratima** the said accused of **CT Cases No. 1505/2024, U/S 135 Indian Electricity Act, PS Baba Haridas Nagar, Dwarka Distt., New Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.10.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Harleen Singh
Addl. Distt. & Sessions Judge (South-West),
Special Court (Electricity), Court No. 609,
Dwarka Courts, New Delhi
DP/12427/DW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sannhita-2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Kapil S/o Ved Prakash R/o H. No 95 , Village & PS Daurala , Distt. Meerut, U.P.** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 154/2012 U/s 33 Delhi Ex Act & 482 IPC PS Civil Lines, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Kapil** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kapil** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Kapil** accused of **FIR No. 154/2012 U/s 33 Delhi Ex Act & 482 IPC PS Civil Lines, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.10.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Kartik Taparia
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi
DP/11861/N/2026 JMFC-03 Central Distt. Room No. 247
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Auction Notice
Letter No:- DRM/C/AGRA/Parcel/E-AUCTION Dated: 01.09.2026
On behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager- North Central Railway- Agra invites E-Auction as per categories given as under:-

Category: Parcel	Auction Catalogue No.: AGRA-LEASING-51
------------------	--

Asset Details:
1. 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train No. 19818- Sunday, Thursday & Friday
2. 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train No. 20178
3. 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train No. 19818- Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday & Saturday
4. 01 (F1) SLR Unit in Train No. 59814
5. 01 (R1) SLR Unit in Train No. 12195
6. 01 (F1) SLR Unit in Train No. 14854
7. 01 (F1) SLR Unit in Train No. 12180
8. 01 (F1) SLR Unit in Train No. 12195 - Sunday
9. 01 round trip VP Unit in Train No. 15110 - 15109
E-Auction Start Date and Time: Date:- 17.09.2026 Time:- 13:00
E-Auction End Date and Time: Date:- 17.09.2026 Time:- 14:50
Note: Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing module on IREPS website (www.irops.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 2025/26(K)
f North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in x @ CPONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Jitender Pandey S/o Sadau Pandey R/o Jhuggi No. E-266, CSA Colony, WPIA, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 453/2020 U/s 33/38 Delhi Excise Act, PS Ashok Vihar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Jitender Pandey** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Jitender Pandey** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Jitender Pandey** of **case FIR No. 453/2020 U/s 33/38 Delhi Excise Act, PS Ashok Vihar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **12.10.2026**.
By Order
Upasana Satija
CJM, Court No. 108
1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/12286/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice
Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-HQ-2026-197	Approx Cost : ₹ 12456140.00
---	------------------------------------

Description of work:- Mobile Flash butt welding under ADEN/HQ-I sub-division.
Earnest Money: ₹ 249100.00**Date of closing Tender:** 25.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
Date of Completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 12 Months.
• Tender online can be submitted upto **15:00 hrs on 25.09.2026**. • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.irops.gov.in. 2029/26(AK)
f North central railways x @CPONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
Sr. DSTE/North Central Railway, Agra acting for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through Online only (E-Tendering) for the following work:-

Sr. No.: 1	E-Tender No.: AGRA-ST-2026-26
-------------------	--------------------------------------

Name of work: S&T work in connection with the work of (1) Augmentation/ renovation of depot of SSE/Sig/MTJ & SSE/Tele/MTJ with all infrastructure facilities at Mathura (MTJ) of AGC Division (2) Provision of OFC hut in lieu of Porta cabins over the Agra Division.
Approx. Cost of work: ₹ 99,56,372.69 **Tender Closing Date:** 25.09.2026

Sr. No.: 2	E-Tender No.: AGRA-ST-2026-27
-------------------	--------------------------------------

Name of work: Provision of CCTV display of Non-interlocked LC gate at SM room and Engineering control of AGC Division.
Approx. Cost of work: ₹ 3,61,62,314.77 **Tender Closing Date:** 25.09.2026

Sr. No.: 3	E-Tender No.: AGRA-ST-2026-28
-------------------	--------------------------------------

Name of work: Comprehensive annual Maintenance contract of EI system for MTJ-AWR Section (MORA, GDO, DEEG, BEDM, BINR, GVH, JBS, RAH, OTW), AGC-UDMR Section (SSDT, FAB, BAH) & AGO Cantt and signalling circuit LSC & Auto Block Section (ABN & ABS) in MTJ-PWL & JAB-TDL sections of Agra Division for a period of three years.
Approx. Cost of work: ₹ 7,64,61,583.68 **Tender Closing Date:** 25.09.2026

Sr. No.: 4	E-Tender No.: AGRA-ST-2026-29
-------------------	--------------------------------------

Name of work: Comprehensive Annual maintenance contract of Electronic interlocking (E.I.) System of Kyosan Make at 04 stations (PTLI, MIQ, KLB & FTS) in IDH-BXN Section of Agra Division for a period of two years.
Approx. Cost of work: ₹ 1,99,24,758.24 **Tender Closing Date:** 25.09.2026

Sr. No.: 5	E-Tender No.: AGRA-ST-2026-30
-------------------	--------------------------------------

Name of work: Comprehensive Annual maintenance Contract of Frauscher Make Multi Section Digital Axle Counters Jamuna Bridge-Tundla Section & Idgah-Bayana section of Agra Division for a period of 03 years.
Approx. Cost of work: ₹ 2,69,29,119.36 **Tender Closing Date:** 25.09.2026
For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railway Website www.irops.gov.in. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids through web portal www.irops.gov.in up to **15.00 hrs.** on above mentioned date. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. 2027/26 (A)
f North central railways x @CPONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Yogesh Kumar, S/o: Ram Sahai, R/o: H.No. C-14, Mahendra Enclave, Street No. 2 Model Town, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No: 230/2021, U/s: 392/397/411 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms Act, PS: Bharat Nagar Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Yogesh Kumar**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Yogesh Kumar**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Yogesh Kumar, FIR No: 230/2021, U/s: 392/397/411 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms Act, PS: Bharat Nagar Delhi** required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.10.2026**.
By Order
Muneesh Garg
Additional Session Judge-03
Room No. 304
Rohini Court, New Delhi
DP/12310/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
Works Branch Trivandrum Division
E-TENDER NOTICE No. V/W/TVC/8/2026 DATED 31-08-2026
Divisional Railway Manager/Works Branch/Trivandrum Division, Trivandrum-14 for and on behalf of the President of India invites ONLINE tenders for the following works as per tender notice and complete details are given in our e-tender portal www.irops.gov.in

Sl. No.	Description	Approx. Value (in Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit Rs.	Period of Completion in months
1	TVC Division:- Raising and extension of PF No.1 and allied works at KVLK station	65814994	1316300	12
2	ADEN/TVC Subdivision:- RE-PAIRS TO QUARTERS UNDER SSE-W-TVC.	17762522	355300	12
3	Reconstruction of TRD Depot at KTYM	12132734	242700	12
4	Proposed construction of Pedestrian subway in lieu of LC No.33@ km:56/200-300 in ERS-KTYM-KYJ section (Additional crossing)	23398138	468000	8
5	ADEN/ERS Sub-division: Over-hauling and maintenance of LC Lifting barriers for a period of two years	17375390	347500	24
6	ERC greasing, De-stressing, anti-corrosive painting of rails in SSE/P Way /CKJ Jurisdiction	8399160	168000	12
7	ERC greasing, destressing, anti-corrosive painting of rails in "SSE/P Way /AWY Jurisdiction	5003129	100100	12
8	ERS - KTYM - KYJ Section - Pro. Reconstruction of Exg. Bridge No. 297 (1 x 4.57m PSC slab) as 1 x 6.10m RCC box at Km. 58/000 - 100 between Ettumaur and Kottayam stations.	15061992	301200	12
9	ERC greasing, De-stressing and anti-corrosive painting of rails in SSE/P Way /KTYM Jurisdiction	11558636	231200	12
10	TVC Division - Painting of girder bridges and steel structures due in 2025-26.	2273755	45500	6
11	DEN/S Jurisdiction- TTR 52 sets	24916144	498300	12
12	DEN/S Jurisdiction-(a) LIFTING AND PACKING WITH RE-GRADING AND FORMATION TREATMENT of track AT KM 165/800-166/260 UP AND DN LINE(KYJ-TVC) and AT KM 77/900-78/400 UP LINE (ALLP-KYJ), (b) Shifting of crossover at VAK Yard (55A,55B & 56A,56B) for relaxation of PSR at Km 179/400-700 UP&DN in KYJ-TVC Section	31878420	637600	12
13	Proposed Subway at Km 11/686 (27.700 X 8.00 M X 5.50 M RCC Box) in lieu of existing LC No. 16 at KM 11/742 between NCJ-CAPE Railway stations.	90756659	1815100	12

Tender Closing date and time: **SL No. 1 to 13 on 23.09.2026 at 11.00 hrs.**
Note: It is the responsibility of the tenderer to check any Corrigendum issued for any correction or modifications uploaded subsequently in website; the same shall be taken into account while submitting.

Divisional Railway Manager (Works), Trivandrum-14
(For and on behalf of the President of India)

Briefs

Tanvi loses in China Masters

SHEZHEN: In women's singles, Tanvi Sharma, who won the Taipei Open World Tour Super 300 title recently, showed gumption to fight but imploded at the back end to go down 17-21 21-18 16-21 to world No. 9 Tomoka Miyazaki of Japan in the second round.

India's Dhruv Kapila and Tanisha Crasto also bowed out after losing 18-21, 18-21 to Chinese Taipei's Liu Kuang Heng and Hsu Yin Hui in mixed doubles.

Anahat enter London Squash

LONDON: World No. 20 Anahat Singh advanced to the quarterfinals of the London Squash Classic with a thrilling 2-1 win over 11th-ranked Nele Gilis here on Thursday.

Reigning world junior champion Anahat beat eighth seed Gilis 13-11, 4-11, 11-8 in 39 minutes in the second round of the USD 144,000 PSA Gold event in what was their first meeting on the tour.

Anahat will next meet the winner of the match between Malaysian world No. 5 Sivasangari Subramaniam and Egyptian world No. 32 Nadine Garas.

Late on Wednesday, world No. 42 Ramit Tandon lost to eighth seed Mohamed Elshorbagy in the men's second round, the Egyptian-born British world No. 15 winning 12-10, 11-9.

Edin Dzeko announces retirement

SARAJEVO: Edin Dzeko will play a 152nd and final match for Bosnia-Herzegovina next month before ending his 19-year international career.

In an emotional post on Instagram, the 40-year-old striker wrote he would be retiring from national team duty after a Nations League qualifier against Sweden in the Bosnian city of Zenica on October 2.

"Now I feel the time has come to step aside," wrote Dzeko, who played for Bosnia at this year's World Cup in the United States, Canada and Mexico. Dzeko has 73 goals for Bosnia.

TO REACH THE THIRD ROUND AT THE US OPEN

Alcaraz recovers after dropping first set

ASSOCIATED PRESS

New York, September 3

Carlos Alcaraz was already in the final by the time he dropped a set last year in the U.S. Open.

When it happened in his second match this year, Alcaraz tried to look at the positives. After missing four months with a right wrist injury, the extra work might help.

"I wanted to be quick, to be honest. I'm not going to lie," Alcaraz said. "But at the end, I realized that just playing four sets, it was really good for me to test everything physically, to test my body, how I feel, and tomorrow how I'm going to feel after this match."

The defending champion rebounded from a quick deficit by winning eight straight games and beat Jaime Faria 4-6, 6-0, 6-3, 6-2 on Wednesday night. The No. 2-seeded Alcaraz dropped his serve midway through the first set but soon was back to



Carlos Alcaraz, of Spain, returns the ball to Jaime Faria, of Portugal, during the second round of the US Open tennis championships

AP/PTI

playing long stretches of flawless tennis. "After that I just tried to be focused, tried to stay calm and I'm thinking that good things are going to happen again," Alcaraz said. He didn't drop a set last year until

the final against Jannik Sinner, becoming the first man since Roger Federer in 2015 to go through his first six matches without doing so. He then beat Sinner in four sets for his second U.S. Open title. The 23-year-old

Alcaraz then picked up his seventh major title at this year's Australian Open and is on a 16-match winning streak in Grand Slam tournaments.

But after missing the French Open and Wimble-

KEY POINTS

» When it happened in his second match this year, Alcaraz tried to look at the positives

» The defending champion rebounded from a quick deficit by winning eight straight games and beat Jaime Faria 4-6, 6-0, 6-3, 6-2 on Wednesday night

don during his absence, even Alcaraz said he didn't know what to expect in Flushing Meadows, where he won his first major title in 2022 at 19.

Daniil Medvedev, the U.S. Open champion the year before that, said a player of Alcaraz's caliber is always a top contender any time he is in the field.

"We have no idea how Carlos' wrist is going to feel, body is going to feel going later into the tournament, but he's definitely a top favorite for the title," Medvedev said.

Duleep Trophy final: Rahul, Padikkal, Siraj asked to play; Vaibhav, Tilak is Gambhir's call

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New Delhi, September 3

Veteran opener KL Rahul, Sri Lanka series hero Devdutt Padikkal and seasoned pacer Mohammed Siraj have been asked to play the Duleep Trophy final for South Zone against East Zone starting September 6 in Chennai.

It is understood that participation of South Zone skipper Tilak Varma, rising sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi and keeper Ishan Kishan, all of whom are in India's T20I team, will depend on approval from Team India head coach Gautam Gambhir.

"Rahul, Padikkal and Siraj do not have any competitive cricket right now. The national selectors want any India player who is available should play the Duleep Trophy final. The trio played last on August 27. The next they will play



“THE INDIAN TEAM WILL ASSEMBLE IN DELHI ON EITHER SEPT 9 OR 10

is September 27 against West Indies in the ODIs.

"Now Padikkal is not a part of ODIs so he might play India A series. But Duleep final if there is a

chance, they should play," a BCCI source privy to the development told PTI on conditions of anonymity.

In the case of Sooryavanshi, Kishan and Tilak, it will be coach Gambhir's prerogative.

"The Indian team will assemble in Delhi on either September 9 or 10. If head coach wants all three to report as per T20I team's itinerary, then the trio can't play. But if

head coach wants them to play the final and report to Delhi on September 10 late evening, they can also do that," the source added.

Even as the mystery surrounding his impending extension remains after he was excused from the all-important BCCI review meeting due to family commitments, chairman of selectors Ajit Agarkar will be in Chennai to watch the Duleep Trophy final.

As of now his contract gets over on October 4 and it will be interesting whether BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia discusses the matter of his extension with him.

The BCCI is planning to send Mayank Yadav, Karтик Tyagi and left-armers Mohsin Khan to the Asian Games in Japan to help the Indian team's training session as net bowlers on specific request of head coach VVS Laxman.

Team India enters Asia Cup final

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Dubai, September 3

Smriti Mandhana slayed a host of records in her 64-ball 124 as India marched into the Women's Asia Cup final with a dominating 137-run win over Hong Kong here on Thursday.

India raced to 193 for five following a second T20 hundred from Mandhana, who also surpassed Mithali Raj (10868 runs) to become the leading run-getter in Women's Internationals and Meg Lanning for most hundreds (18) across formats.

The wide gulf between India and Hong Kong, playing their first Asia Cup since 2012, was clearly visible as the latter struggled to 16 for one in the powerplay, effectively putting the stiff target out of their reach. Hong Kong eventually ended at 56 all out in 16.2 overs.

India pacer Nandni Sharma swung the ball



Smriti Mandhana in action

THE WIDE GULF BETWEEN INDIA AND HONG KONG, PLAYING THEIR FIRST ASIA CUP SINCE 2012, WAS CLEARLY VISIBLE AS THE LATTER STRUGGLED TO 16 FOR ONE IN THE POWERPLAY

both ways and got rid of opener Mariko Hill with a

beauty. None of the batters were able to take on the Indian attack, showing their lack of exposure to top flight cricket.

It was India's second win in as many games and the overwhelming title favourites will take on Pakistan on Saturday.

Earlier, Mandhana made up for a sedate start rather quickly and shared a 74-run stand with opening partner Shafali Verma (28 off 17) to set the tone for the innings.

Agarkar misses BCCI meeting, no discussion on contract extension

While the BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia says that Rohit Sharma is playing superbly, what more do you want

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Mumbai, September 3

The chairman of the senior men's selection committee Ajit Agarkar on Thursday missed the BCCI's review meeting of India's limited-overs tours of Ireland and England, attracting plenty of attention.

India had suffered a shocking 0-2 defeat to Ireland in the two-match series before the tour of England, where they lost the five-match T20I series

1-4 and suffered a 1-2 loss in the ODI series.

The board held a review meeting, which Saikia said was called at a short notice, here at the BCCI headquarters. It was also attended by Test and ODI captain Shubman Gill, T20I skipper Shreyas Iyer, head coach Gautam Gambhir, director of cricket at the Centre of Excellence VVS Laxman, and the board's officials.

Agarkar, according to Saikia, was not in town

THE BOARD HELD A REVIEW MEETING, WHICH SAIKIA SAID WAS CALLED AT A SHORT NOTICE, HERE AT THE BCCI HEADQUARTERS

and was not able to join the meeting via video conferencing as well.

"Today he was out of station, he could not be a part of the meeting because this meeting was called at a very short notice.

Our head of the selection committee, Ajit, was

not in town so he could not join it. He was in such area that he could not join online also in spite of our best efforts," Saikia told reporters.

Saikia said there was no discussion on the extension of contract for chief Agarkar, whose contract runs till the end of September.

ber. "There was no such discussion in today's meeting," Saikia replied when asked if there was any discussion on the matter of the contract extension.

The BCCI secretary maintained that the review meeting was focussed only on the performances on Ireland and England tours, and on the matter of fitness and frequent injury to players.

BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia strongly defended Rohit Sharma amid spec-

ulation over the former India skipper's future in the ODI team, saying the veteran batter has been "playing superbly" and there is no reason to question his place in the side.

Rohit, who now plays only one format after retiring from Test cricket last year and T20Is in 2024, has faced constant scrutiny over his position in the Indian ODI side. "He is playing superbly in all matches. So what more do you want? In

the last match (against England), he scored 138 runs, so why is there speculation? I do not want to give some fodder for the speculators," Saikia told reporters after the BCCI's review meeting here.

With Agarkar as the chairman of the selection committee, India had reached the final of the ODI World Cup in 2023 while the team won the T20 World Cup two consecutive times in 2024 and 2026.

News at a glance

Shooting: Veteran Mairaj targets maiden Asiad medal

NEW DELHI: At 50, Mairaj Ahmad Khan is still chasing his first Asian Games medal, but the veteran skeet shooter is equally excited about what lies ahead for Indian shooting, predicting the country will have "the best team" across trap, skeet, rifle and pistol over the next four years.

Mairaj believes Indian shooting is poised for a big rise, crediting government-backed programmes such as Khelo India for creating a stronger pathway for the next generation of athletes.

Mairaj will be making his third appearance at the continental event.

Badrinath: Dhoni ruled out continuing as Impact Player

NEW DELHI: Mahendra Singh Dhoni has told former Chennai Super Kings batter Subramaniam Badrinath that he does not intend to continue as an Impact Player, adding another twist to the uncertainty surrounding his participation in the 2027 Indian Premier League.

The Impact Player rule could potentially have offered the veteran wicketkeeper-batter a way to prolong his IPL career further by reducing his workload, but Dhoni has made it clear that he wants to remain a full-time wicketkeeper if he continues playing.

India unbeaten on Day 1 of Pickleball WC in Vietnam

MUMBAI: The Indian contingent was unbeaten on the first day of the team event at the Pickleball World Cup in Da Nang, Vietnam.

This marks the end of the league stage where a dominant India defeated Antigua Barbados, Israel and Czech Republic.

The India pro squad consisting of Harsh Mehta, Arjun Singh, Anish Froilan, Aman Patel, Pearl Amalsadiwala, Naomi Amalsadiwala, Aaliya Ebrahim and Mihika Yadav beat Antigua & Barbados and Israel with a score line of 6-0 each.



Maharaja Padmanabh Singh of Team Jaipur, (right), in action during the a Polo match, at the Rajasthan Polo Club Ground, in Jaipur on Thursday

PTI

CLUB SAYS MATTER ALREADY RESOLVED

AIFF hands Churchill ban on player registration

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, September 3

All India Football Federation (AIFF) handed Churchill Brothers FC a national ban on player registration on the directive of FIFA Disciplinary Committee after a pay dispute but the Goan club claimed that the matter has now been resolved.

The matter is related to alleged unpaid dues owed to English forward Kurtis Owen Guthrie whom Churchill Brothers, which is set to play in the upcoming Indian Super League season, signed before the 2024-25 season.

“This circular is to notify all the Member Associations (MA) and stakeholders of the AIFF that a National Ban on the registration of new players has been imposed on the Club Churchill Brothers FC Goa, a club registered with the Goa Football Associ-



Representational Image

ation,” the AIFF said in a letter dated September 2. “Imposition of the ban will be effective immediately in accordance with the correspondence received from FIFA’s Head of Disciplinary dated 01 September 2026. We further request all the MAs to communicate the same to all the affiliated units and registered clubs under your Association. This is

for your information and necessary action.” A national ban on player registration could have hurt Churchill Brothers, though the club would have the option of signing free agent foreign players or may be on loan. Churchill Brothers claimed that they were initially unaware of the sanction due to a technical issue on their official

email, but they promptly issued the full payment to Guthrie. After that, the club requested FIFA to immediately lift the transfer ban. “Churchill Brothers FC Goa has made the full payment due today (September

3) in relation to the matter concerning Mr Kurtis Owen Guthrie. We were notified of the registration ban only yesterday,” the club said in a communication. “Unfortunately, due to a technical issue with

our official email ID, we had not been receiving the relevant updates and notifications through the FIFA TMS system. Consequently, we were not aware of the ban until the notification reached us yesterday.

M. P. MADHYA KSHETRA VIDYUT VITARAN CO. LTD.
(Govt. of M.P. Undertaking)
Nishtha Parisar, Bijalee Nagar, Govindpura, Bhopal-23
Phone No. : 0755-2602033-36, Fax : 2589821, 2586636
Ref. : MD/MK/04/Abgd.NIT/1952
Date : 03.09.2026

TENDER NOTICE
MPMKVVCL, Bhopal, invites following bids through e-tendering :-

Tender Specification Number	Particulars	Approx. Value (Rs. Lakh)	Tender Fee Including GST @18% (In Rs.)	Pre-Bid Meeting	Date of Opening of Tender
MD/MK/04/1324	Appointment of Agency for Promotion, Outreach & Branding, Digital Marketing and Production Work of MPMKVCL, Bhopal.	120.00	5900.00	15.09.2026 at 03:30 PM	25.09.2026 at 03:30 PM

Other details are available on Company website <https://portal.mpcz.in> & <https://mptenders.gov.in>
M.P. Madhyam/127884/2026
CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (PROC.)

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice
Invitation of tender through E-tendering (e-Procurement Systems)

NIT No.	6S-Efile-317880R3Tender
Name of Work and its location	Tender for "Refurbishment of LHB Coaches (Pantry car) as per scope of work at RCNK/SNP."
Approx Cost of work	Tender Cost: Rs. 3,58,84,115.80/- including GST (Rs. Three Crore, Fifty-Eight Lakh, Eighty Four Thousand, One Hundred Fifteen and Eighty Paise only)
Earnest Money	Rs. 7,17,700.00/-
Completion period of work	12 months from date of LOA
Cost of Tender document on cash/by post	NIL
Date and Time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Upto 15:00 hrs. on 25/09/2026
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
No. 6S-Efile-317880R3Tender Dated:-	03/09/2026 3040/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Abhishek Gupta** S/o Prakash Chand Gupta R/o H.No. 2036, Gali No. 06, Kailash nagar, Gandhi Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 357/2020 U/S 356/379/411/34 IPC** at **P.S. Krishna Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Abhishek Gupta** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Abhishek Gupta** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s **82 Cr. P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Abhishek Gupta** accused of **FIR No. 357/2020 U/S 356/379/411/34 IPC** at **P.S. Krishna Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.10.2026**.

By Order: **Shri P. Bhargav Rao,**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (East),
Room No. 03, Second Floor,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi.

DP/12370/SHD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Lalit @ Harish @ Raka**, S/o: Shatrughan, R/o: C-120, Satyampuram Jharodia Kalan Colony, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 326/2022, U/s 324/341/34 IPC, P.S.: Hari Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Lalit @ Harish @ Raka** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Lalit @ Harish @ Raka** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Lalit @ Harish @ Raka** accused of case **FIR No. 326/2022, U/s 324/341/34 IPC, P.S.: Hari Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Moksha Bains
Judicial Magistrate First Class-II (West)
Court No. 31, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/12455/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

WET CANTEN : DG NCC CAMP

- DG NCC invites tender as per Letter No. B/89915/AP-2/2003/Land (Policy & ANC)/75 dt 28 Sept 2017 for running of Wet Canteen at DG NCC Camp, Parade Ground, Delhi Cantt, New Delhi – 110010.
- Duration of contract will be one year wef 01 Oct 2026 to 30 Sep 2027.
- Participation** – Strictly as per Letter quoted at Para 1, 100% reservation to War Widows/ Widows of Defence Personnel killed while on duty, Disabled Soldier, Ex-Servicemen & Spouses / Widows of Ex-Servicemen.
- Tender Opening Dt** – 15 Sep 2026
Pre Bid Meeting – 10 Sept 2026 at 1500 hrs at AQMG Coord Office, HQ DG NCC, RK Puram, New Delhi – 110066.
- Please contact underneath for any queries.

Telephone – 011-35459364
Email – aqmgcoord@nccindia.nic.in

UJVN LTD.
H.O.: 'UJJWAL', Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 0135 - 2763808, Fax 0135-2763508
CIN No. : U40101UR2001S0002306, Website : www.ujvn.com

Tender Notice
Dated 03.09.2026
Office of Executive Engineer (Maint.), Khodri Power House, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tenders are given below,
Tender No:-08 & 09/EE/(Maint.)/Khodri/2026-27.
Name of work: (1) Refurbishment of Centralized Greasing Lubrication System of all machines of Khodri Power Station.
(2) Replacement of various Valves (2", 4" & 6" Oil & Water Pipe line) of all units of Khodri Power Station.
Estimated cost (In Lakh): Rs. 15.50 (GST extra) & Rs. 09.70 (GST extra) respectively.
Date of availability of bid Document on website: 05.09.2026, 10:00 Hrs.
Last date for submission of tender : 25.09.2026, 16:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website "www.ujvn.com".
Executive Engineer (Maint.), khodri power station
"Avoid Wasteful use of Electricity"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Shivam @ Aman** S/o Suresh Kumar R/o Jhuggi No. 120/143, Indra Camp, Gali No. 05, Vikaspuri, Delhi has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **e-FIR No. 016432/2025 U/s 317(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S. Anand Parbat, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shivam @ Aman** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shivam @ Aman** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shivam @ Aman** of case **e-FIR No. 016432/2025 U/s 317(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S. Anand Parbat, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.11.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Ankur Panghal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
West, Room No. 336A
DP/12176/CD/2026 (Court Matter)

Aahida enters semis at KSLTA J30 Bengaluru

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Bengaluru, September 3

Local junior tennis players continued to make their presence felt as the KSLTA World Tennis Tour Junior J30 Bengaluru by moving into the semifinals, with Aahida Singh producing the stand-out result in the girls' singles quarterfinals by defeating third seed and citymate Disha Kumar 6-4 6-4. Aahida and Disha, both Bengaluru players, produced a closely fought contest, matching each other with some excellent stroke play. Aahida kept her composure at the crucial moments to take both sets 6-4 and book her place in the last four.

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform public in general that Kotak Mahindra bank Ltd has organized an auction in below mention respect of Vehicles. **VEHICLES FOR SALE**

- 1) TATA MOTORS T_INTRAV20
REG. NO. DL1LAM6617-YOM- 2024
 - 2) BHARATBENZ BB3723R
REG. NO. GJ12BZ0255-YOM- 2023
 - 3) TATA MOTORS TATA_INTRA
REG. NO. DL1LAM4251-YOM -2024
 - 4) MAH BOLERO MAX
REG. NO. DL1LX3803-YOM- 2016
 - 5) MARUTIS EECO
REG. NO. DL1LT9625-YOM- 2014
 - 6) MARUTIS SUPCARYCNG
REG.NO. DL1LAN3954-YOM -2024
 - 7) TATA MOTORS TATA_INTRA
REG. NO. DL1LAQ3070-YOM -2025
 - 8) ASHOK_LEY AL1615CNG
REG. NO. HR38AD0560-YOM- 2022
 - 9) ASHOK_LEY ECOMET1615
REG. NO. UP14LT3710-YOM -2022
 - 10) TATA MOTORS T2518FBGD
REG. NO. UP777264-YOM- 2015
 - 11) TATA MOTORS TSIGNA5530
REG. NO. HR58C3613-YOM -2023
- UNDER HYPOTHECATION WITH M/S KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK IS UNDER SALE IN ITS "AS IS WHERE IS CONDITION" INTERESTED PARTIES CAN GIVE THEIR QUOTATIONS WITH IN 7 DAYS AT
BRANCH ADDRESS: KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK 3RD FLOOR, PLOT NO 7, SECTOR 125, NOIDA-201313
OR CONTACT : PUNIT PARASHAR KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK LTD. CONTACT NO. 8377905498
EMAIL-punit.parashar@kotak.com

M. P. POWER GENERATING COMPANY LIMITED
(Government of Madhya Pradesh Undertaking)
ISO 9001:2015 Certified
O/o Executive Director (Material Management)
Block No.8, Ground Floor, Shakti Bhavan, Vidhyut Nagar, Rampur, Jabalpur 482008 (M.P.)
Phone No. 0761-2702700, E-mail : cesnmpgcl@rediffmail.com
Website : www.mppgcl.mp.gov.in, CIN-U-40109MP2001SGCO14882
Date : 01.09.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT) NO. CE (MM) NIT-301
"Through e-Tendering Process Only"

M.P. Power Generating Co Ltd. invites Electronic Tenders from reputed/established Manufacturers/ Authorized Dealers/Authorized Distributor/Suppliers/Contractor/Service Provider/Firm for the following items/Works for various Power Stations of MPPGCL:

S N	Tender ID	Tender Particulars	Estimated Tender Cost (Rs. in Lakh)	EMD (Rs in Lakh)	Date and Time for closing of online submission	Date and Time for opening of e-tender
1	2026_MPPGC_533223_1	Manufacture and supply of LT Cables for SGTPS, MPPGCL, Birsinghpur	902.00	9.02	08.09.2026 Upto 18:30 Hrs.	10.09.2026 From 12:30 Hrs. onwards

These tender is being invited through an e-tendering system. For viewing detailed NIT, downloading tender documents and participating in Electronic Tenders, for any clarifications and/or due date extension or corrigendum, please visit the website www.mptenders.gov.in regularly. Any clarifications and/or due date extension or corrigendum shall be issued on the website www.mptenders.gov.in only.
M.P. Madhyam/127881/2026 //SAVE ELECTRICITY// **CHIEF ENGINEER (MM)**

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
e-Procurement Notice
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)
e-mail ee-roh-hp@nic.in

The Executive Engineer HPPWD Rohru Distt Shimla H.P on behalf of Governor of H.P invites item rate, bids, in electronic tendering system, in 2 cover system for the under mentioned work from the eligible and approved contractors/firms registered with HPPWD Department.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Starting date for downloading Bid	Earnest money	Deadline for submission bid
1	R/R Damage to Kafhu karela Pethadhar Bajeshal road km 0/00 to 7/500 (Sh/- Providing and laying G-II,G-III, M/T in km 0/00 to 5/500 Under PDNA 2025	19251978/-	10-9-2026	385040	17-9-2026
2	RR Damage to Chirgaon gushali Rohal road km 0/00 to 16/00 (Sh/- Providing and laying G-II,G-III M/T in km 4/00 to 9/00) Under PDNA 2025	17886312/-	10-9-2026	357726	17-9-2026
3	RR Damage to Chirgaon to Chitlala road km 0/00 to 5/450 (Sh/- Providing and laying G-II,G-III, M/T in km 0/00 to 5/450) under PDNA 2025	17687711/-	10-9-2026	353754	17-9-2026
4	Providing Periodical maintenance on Devdhar Ranol road km 0/00 to 8/00(Sh/- Providing and laying prime Coat/Periodical maintenance at Rd 0/00 to 8/00) Under PMGSY Incentive 2026-27 and Five year maintenance	16701162/-	10-9-2026	334023	17-9-2026
5	Providing Periodical maintenance on Shulthar to Shollan road km 0/00 to 3/00 PMGSY Incentive 2025-26(Sh/- Providing and laying prime Coat/Periodical maintenance at Rd 0/00 to five and five year maintenance)	3511843/-	10-9-2026	70237	17-9-2026

The Bidders are advised to note other details for tenders and letter No.PWD(B) A(3) / 2020 dated 12.01.2023 issued by secretary PW) to the Govt. of Himachal Pradesh Public Works Department from the department website www.hptenders.gov.in and any corrigendum will be uploaded on the website only.
Executive Engineer HPPWD Division Rohru Distt Shimla HP
Ro.No 3131/2026-2027

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, धनबाद
शुद्धि पत्र

सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि इस कार्यालय के ई- निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या 09/RWD/DHANBAD/26-27 दिनांक 17.08.2026 जिसका पीओआर 387732 Rural Works Department (26-27) एवं ई- निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या 10/RWD/DHANBAD/26-27 दिनांक 17.08.2026 जिसका पीओआर 387832 Rural Works Department (26-27) प्रकाशित निविदा की तिथि में निम्नांकित संशोधन किया जाता है।

क्रमांक	विवरण	पूर्व में प्रकाशित तिथि	संशोधित तिथि
1	वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि	24.08.2026	09.09.2026
2	ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	16.09.2026 अपराह्न 5.00 बजे	29.09.2026 अपराह्न 5.00 बजे
3	निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय	18.09.2026 अपराह्न 3.30 बजे	01.10.2026 अपराह्न 3.30 बजे

शेष सभी शर्तें यथावत रहेंगी।
कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, धनबाद
PR 389019 (Rural Work Department)26-27'D

Govt. of Jharkhand
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
Field Survey Division, Advance Planning, Road Construction Department,
Nirupan Bhawan, 4th floor, 56-Set Chowk, Doranda, Ranchi-834002, e-mail-- eercdapfsdran-jhr@nic.in

e-Procurement (very Short Tender Notice)
Letter of Invitation (LOI) No.-09/2026-27
National Competitive Bidding (Two Bid System)
e-Tender Ref No:- RCD/FSD /AP/ RAN/09/26-27 Dated 03.09.2026

1	Name Of Work	Consultancy services for preparation of Detailed project report for construction of the path from Maina Bagicha veer Budhu Bhagat Chowk to Hostel Road including proposal/ Replacement of culverts and bridges, ROB/RUB if any required, complete Land Acquisition Proposal including ownership details all complete as per latest guidelines, Resettlement and Rehabilitation Plan and Forest Diversion Proposal including clearance of all stages etc as required, at Lohardaga in the state of Jharkhand.
2	Tentative Length	0.370 km
3	Period of Completion of Work	30 Days
4	Cost of Tender Document & Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Cost of Tender Document :- Rs 5,000/- (Rupees Five Thousand) (Non-Refundable) through online mode only. EMD :- Rs- 10,000/- (Rupees Ten thousand) through online mode only. As per the Departmental Letter no.- 4652(S) dated 06.10.2023, cost of tender document and Earnest Money Deposit will be received in online mode only through e-procurement portal (https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in) by Internet banking/ NEFT/ RTGS facility as per Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) issued by Information Technology & e-Governance Department, Government of Jharkhand vide letter no- 120 dated 03.10.2023.
5	Mode of Bid Submission	e-tendering (http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
6	Date/Time of Publication of Tender on Website	07.09.2026, 17:00 PM
7	Last date and Time of submission of Tender (With Tender Fee and EMD)	15.09.2026, not later than 16:00 hrs
8	Date of opening of Bid	16.09.2026 at 16:30 hrs Chief Engineer (Comm), Road Construction Department, Engineer Hostel No-2, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004
9	Place of Opening	
10	Designation and Contact no. of e-Procurement Officer	Executive Engineer, Field Survey Division, Advance Planning, RCD, Ranchi. Mobile No-8051090751

Note:-Only e-Tender shall be accepted.

Executive Engineer,
Field Survey Division,A.P
PR 389026 Road(26-27)#D Road Construction Department,Ranchi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Girender Singh @ Greg Atri**, S/o: Dharampal Singh, R/o: H.No-266, P/31, Ward No-2, Mehrauli, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 142/2019, Dated: 23/02/2019, U/s: 498A/406/34 IPC, P.S. Mehrauli, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Girender Singh @ Greg Atri** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Girender Singh @ Greg Atri** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Girender Singh @ Greg Atri** of **P.S. Mehrauli, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **12.10.2026**.

By Order
Dr. Aneez Bishnoi
JMFC (Mahila Court)-01,
South Distt., Room No. 208,
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/12387/SD/2026

'DON'T BELIEVE IN BOXING MYSELF'

Abhay Verma said he consciously seeks roles that allow him to reinvent himself

Munjya' and 'Operation Safed Sagar' star Abhay Verma said he doesn't want to confine himself to a particular image, which is why he is consciously seeking roles that allow him to reinvent himself.

Verma has been lauded for his nuanced portrayal of Flying Officer Rajpal Singh Dhaliwal, nicknamed 'Munjya', in 'Operation Safed Sagar'. "I've made a conscious choice not to get boxed as an actor. I started off my journey playing a transgender role (in 'Safed'). Then I went on to do 'Family Man', in which I played a sleeper cell operative. 'Munjya' as a horror-comedy, was completely different," the actor told PFI in an interview.

Verma said his subsequent projects, including 'Operation Safed Sagar', Shah Rukh Khan-starrer 'King' and 'Laikey Laikaa' with Rasha Thadani, have allowed him to explore a different side of his craft. "I want to reinvent with every character. Now, people want to be

surprised," he said, adding that he is thankful to casting directors, including Mukesh Chhabra, for seeing him differently for each of these roles.

For Verma, being unrecognisable in 'Operation Safed Sagar', from his previous work 'Munjya', is the biggest compliment an actor can receive. "Thankfully, people said, 'Oh, is that the guy in 'Munjya'? I believe you get what you seek. I was seeking different roles and characters and I got them."

Abhay said playing a fighter pilot was a 'dream come true' moment for him because his childhood aspiration was to become a pilot. He said the opportunity to portray a war hero like Dhaliwal, whom he described as a 'legend', came with a sense of responsibility. He said he drew inspiration from the conversation with Air Force personnel, who had known Dhaliwal.

"Dhaliwal sir was one of the best

pilots that we had and we lost him sadly in 2009. When we were shooting at the air force stations, his courage, pride and flamboyance that he carried were spoken about. So, I took a lot from that," he said. PFI

HE HAS BEEN LAUDED FOR HIS NUANCED PORTRAYAL OF FLYING OFFICER RAJPAL SINGH DHALIWAL IN 'OPERATION SAFED SAGAR'



'Not getting a lot of casting calls'

Elliot Page played the role of Ithacan soldier Sinon in 'The Odyssey'

Elliot Page, who played the role of Ithacan soldier Sinon in Christopher Nolan's 'The Odyssey', said he isn't getting a lot of casting calls after his role in the movie, which has become the second highest-grossing movie of the year.

In an interview with 'On Film...', Page was asked if he must be getting 'a zillion calls after this movie'. "No, Kevin, I'm not," Page said. "So, let's - if someone wants to call me..."

A surprised McCarthy then asked Page if really another job doesn't have lined up. "Not really. I'd really love to do good work. That's what I'd love to do."

Page, born as Ellen Page and came out as a trans man in 2021, said he is planning to be more proactive in reaching out to directors. "I was seen in a certain way before and it's different now."

The casting of Page, who was also part of Nolan's 'Inception' before his transition, in 'The Odyssey' was met with a lot of back-



PAGE SAID HE IS PLANNING TO BE MORE PROACTIVE IN REACHING OUT TO DIRECTORS

lash from right-wing social media, with many assuming that the director had cast him in the role of Achilles.

In the film, Page appears in the first scenes of the movie as Sinon, a soldier who is left with the Trojan horse, with Odysseus (Matt Damon) not revealing to him that he and others are hiding inside the horse. He is killed in the initial scenes of the movie. Odysseus has another encounter with Sinon in the land of the dead. PFI

'Stories are always dangerous to people who peddle in fear'

Hollywood star George Clooney received an honorary Golden Lion for lifetime achievement at the opening ceremony of the Venice Film Festival and used his time on stage to deliver a moving speech about the importance of stories and human empathy.

Clooney attended the movie gala with his wife, Amal Clooney and close friend Laura Dern, who presented him with the honour. Dern called Clooney one of her oldest and closest friends and invited his other friends and collaborators, including Brad Pitt, Adam Sandler, Steven Soder-



bergh, CAA partner and his longtime agent of 25 years, Bryan Lourd, Alexander Payne and Noah Baumbach to speak for the actor, reported 'Variety'.

When Clooney's time came to speak, he referenced the current political climate to emphasise the importance of sto-

ries. He said he's learned a lot over the years by coming to places like Venice and experiencing world cinema. "Nobody laughs in a different language. Nobody cries in a different language. Parents worry the same. Kids dream the same. Love looks remarkably similar in language, which makes it hard to believe that we're as different as we're constantly being told. We're living through a moment in time where people in charge, the people with the most money, are telling us to fear one another. But we know better than that, don't we? Because history does teach us a lesson." PFI

KUNAL KEMMU ON DIRECTING SHARMILA TAGORE IN 'VIBE'

'Proud I could call action & cut on legend like her'

Actor-director Kunal Kemmu said approaching mother-in-law Sharmila Tagore for a cameo in his upcoming movie 'Vibe' was a shot in the dark and she was gracious enough to do the part.

Kemmu, who is married to cinema icon's daughter Soha Ali Khan, recalled how his mother-in-law asked him for the film's synopsis before saying yes. "It was a shot in the dark. I told her there was this part; it was a cameo and if she would play that part. She said, 'Can I know the synopsis of the film?' So, then I told her. And she said that was a trick question; she was going to do it anyway. So, she was gracious enough. I think it's one of those check boxes that I got to tick

KEMMU, WHO IS MARRIED TO CINEMA ICON'S DAUGHTER SOHA ALI KHAN, RECALLED HOW HIS MOTHER-IN-LAW ASKED HIM FOR THE FILM'S SYNOPSIS BEFORE SAYING YES

off. I'm very happy and proud that I could call action and cut on a legend like her," he told reporters at the trailer launch of the film.

'Vibe', his follow-up to the 2024 blockbuster 'Madgaon Express', is a spy comedy that features him as a man who is roped in for a secret mission against his will. The movie also

stars Sparsh Srivastav of 'Laapataa Ladies' fame as his friend and Preity Zinta as a seasoned spy named Madam H.

Kemmu said whether one likes it or not, the box office performance of a film is like a report card for a filmmaker and determines their next project. "Based on this, you will get a chance. You will get budgets ahead. And you will get a chance to make films. If you don't make good films, they won't trust you. If you make bad films, they will still trust you. So, I mean, it's all correlated. I think that's the best and the worst thing about the box office. And that's how theatres have always worked. So, that's why I think it's more important now." PFI



WRITING CHOSE ME: SANDEEP JAIN

From 'Kota Factory' and 'Criminal Justice 4' to 'Operation Safed Sagar', he had an unlikely journey from engineering to storytelling

AUTHOR



DR SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

In the high-stakes world of Indian entertainment, where connections can often open doors faster than craft, Sandeep Jain stands out as an outsider who made his way in through storytelling. An IIT Delhi graduate from the 2011 batch, Jain left a Rs 22-lakh annual package in 2013 to pursue the uncertain dream of filmmaking. What began as an acting stint soon evolved into screenwriting - an accidental calling that has since brought him critical acclaim, a Filmfare Award and most recently, Netflix's war series 'Operation Safed Sagar'.

"Writing chose me," Jain says. Raised in a middle-class family in Shivpur, Madhya Pradesh, he grew up with little exposure to cinema; his father once delivered milk door to door. An IIT degree and corporate job offered security before he took the

filmmaking plunge. Today, the son of a milkman creates stories and emotions that resonate with audiences across the country.

His breakthrough came with TVF's 'Kota Factory', which captured the pressures of IIT coaching and later moved to 'Netflix'. Co-writing Tabbar earned him the Filmfare Award for 'Best Story (Series)', which he calls 'clearing IIT in this industry'. He dedicated the honour to his father while walking the red carpet as a boy from Shivpur. His subsequent credits include 'Criminal Justice Season 4', 'Kanneda' on 'JioHotstar' and 'Kan Khajura' on 'SonyLIV'.

Most recently, Jain led the writers' room on Netflix's 'Operation Safed Sagar', centred on the Indian Air Force's role in the 1999 Kargil War. The research was exhaustive, involving multiple interviews with pilots and layers of pre-war and wartime anecdotes. The challenge was to maintain a balance between factual authenticity and dramatic necessity.

"What audiences see is only about 20 per cent of the material we gathered," he notes.

WHAT BEGAN AS AN ACTING STINT SOON EVOLVED INTO SCREENWRITING, AN ACCIDENTAL CALLING THAT HAS SINCE BROUGHT HIM CRITICAL ACCLAIM

The task was to capture the essence of real voices without turning the series into either dry documentation or excessive fiction. The result sought to present a grounded, human war drama rather than a jingoistic spectacle.

Jain doesn't romanticise screenwriting. In India, it remains a long and often thankless profession. A writer may spend more than a year on a series, only to see it pass through multiple hands before reaching the screen. Royalties, standard in many Western markets, remain rare in India, with only a handful of production houses offering them. Payment delays and outright non-payment are common enough that even writers behind successful shows can struggle to make ends meet in Mumbai.

Jain has experienced these challenges himself but credits his entrepreneurial streak with helping him weather setbacks. He urges newcomers to insist on clear contracts rather than relying on verbal assurances, noting that writers can be particularly

vulnerable during negotiations.

The Screenwriters Association continues to push for better terms, but exploitation persists. Jain believes this drives many talented writers towards direction and other roles for greater creative control, respect and financial security. Despite television's different dynamics, he says film and streaming still undervalue the labour that begins with a blank page.

That blank page remains the toughest part, with every assignment demanding reinvention. Jain credits his ability to balance emotion and logic to a personal quirk - a simian line on his palm. Though he does not believe in palmistry, he sees an interesting parallel with his approach to characters and plots.

Looking ahead, Jain has founded Kahaani Adda to develop stories rather than mere marketable products. He aims to explore diverse genres and the full spectrum of 'navarasa',

the nine aesthetic emotions of the 'Natyashastra'. Two theatrical films with major studios are lined up, while his eight-episode directorial series is in post-production.

Ambitious but patient, Jain hopes to explore acting, directing and producing, drawing inspiration from Farhan Akhtar. As an outsider, he knows establishing oneself in the industry can take time.

For now, he remains grateful to tell stories that matter - stories he hopes deliver emotions as reliably as his father once delivered milk. His journey from IIT Delhi to 'Netflix' is a reminder that in an industry driven by connections, content can still clear the hardest exams.

